

Supplementary materials

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1 Introduction

This document presents graphical results generated as output from analytic workflows written in *R* language and available in the public GitHub repository.

2 Species discrimination and prediction

To classify the CHC samples collected from mixed colonies, we need a measure which positions a sample between the *F. sanguinea* and *F. fusca* CHC profiles. Therefore, using `mixOmics` R package [Le Cao et al., 2025], we performed a discriminant analysis training the model on the chemical data collected from the filed colonies in the earlier study [Włodarczyk and Szczepaniak, 2017]. The model was subsequently used to predict identity of new samples.

2.1 Species markers

To figure out the importance of each input variable in the prediction of the species identity made by discriminant model we calculated the weights from the following product matrix [Tenenhaus, 1998, Rohart et al. [2017]].

$$\mathbf{W}(\mathbf{P}^T \mathbf{W})^{-1} \mathbf{C}, \mathbf{P} = \mathbf{X} \mathbf{V} \mathbf{C} = \mathbf{Y} \mathbf{V},$$

where

$\mathbf{W}$ is the matrix of loading vectors with the number of rows corresponding to the number of input variables and the number of columns corresponding to the number of the latent components

$\mathbf{V}$ is the matrix of the coordinates of each observation on latent components

$\mathbf{X}$ is the input data matrix

To project the weights assigned to principal components onto the original variables one has to reverse data transformation. Technically, this is achieved by multiplication by pseudoinverse of the rotation matrix

produced by PCA. We use pseudoinverse since the rotation matrix has been reduced by removing principal components with low variance.

$$\mathbf{R}^+ \mathbf{W} (\mathbf{P}^\top \mathbf{W})^{-1} \mathbf{C},$$

where $\mathbf{R}^+$ denotes the pseudoinverse of rotation matrix from PCA.

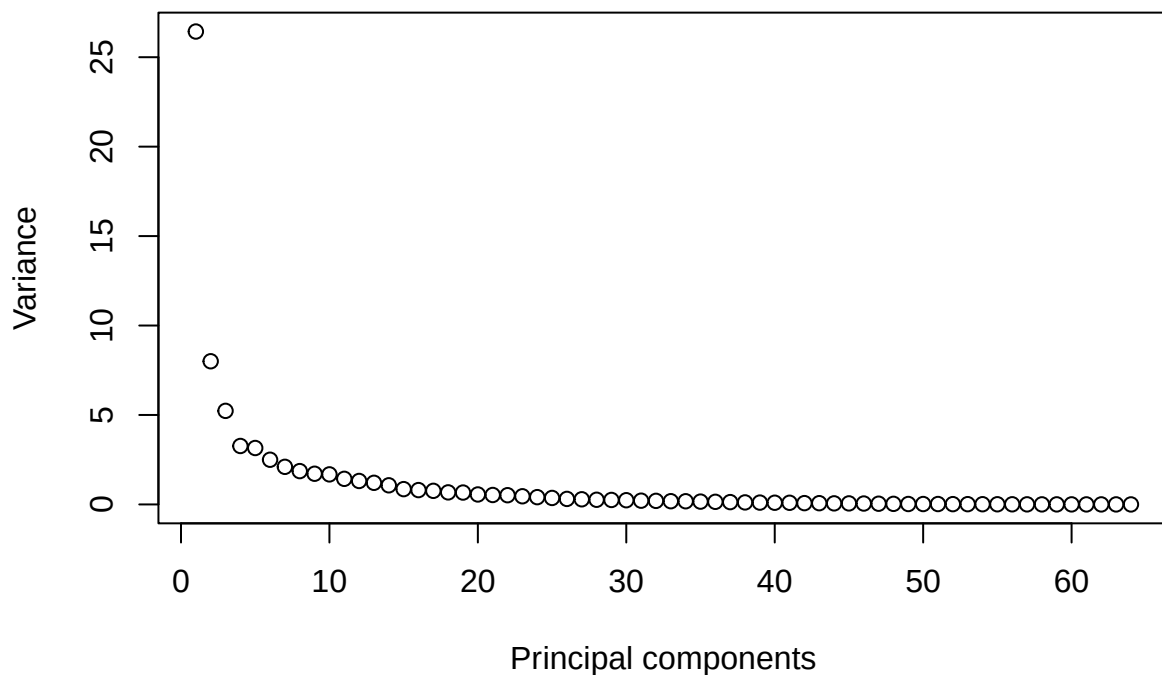


Figure S1 : Variance of each principal component. Data was fed into the discriminat model to find features separating both species.

Table S1 : List of the peaks with the species identity score indicating their importance as a marker of *F. fusca* or *F. sanguinea* samples.

Peak ID	Compound	Marker score	fusca marker	sanguinea marker
15	4-MeC24	-0.0249041	TRUE	FALSE
60	13,17-diMeC29	-0.0225439	TRUE	FALSE
14	6-MeC24	-0.0183227	TRUE	FALSE
10	3-MeC23	-0.0179422	TRUE	FALSE
19	4,12-diMeC24	-0.0178830	TRUE	FALSE
12	3,13-; 3,11-; 3,9-; 3,7-diMeC23	-0.0178489	TRUE	FALSE
6	11-Me-C23 + 9-Me-C23	-0.0174140	TRUE	FALSE
7	7-Me-C23	-0.0172762	TRUE	FALSE
33	6-MeC26	-0.0162962	TRUE	FALSE
37	7,x-; 5,x-; 10,14-diMeC26	-0.0161379	TRUE	FALSE
31	3,13-diMeC25	-0.0159869	TRUE	FALSE
32	14-; 10-MeC26 + 3,7,11-triMeC25	-0.0156195	TRUE	FALSE

Table S1 : List of the peaks with the species identity score indicating their importance as a marker of *F. fusca* or *F. sanguinea* samples. (*continued*)

Peak ID	Compound	Marker score	fusca marker	sanguinea marker
13	12-; 11-; 10-; 9-; 8-MeC24	-0.0155301	TRUE	FALSE
49	7,11-diMeC27	-0.0148635	TRUE	FALSE
40	4,12-diMeC26	-0.0138695	TRUE	FALSE
69	C31	-0.0134870	FALSE	FALSE
22	13-; 11-; 9-MeC25	-0.0131439	FALSE	FALSE
21	4,12,16-triMeC24	-0.0131399	FALSE	FALSE
11	C24	-0.0125738	FALSE	FALSE
44	7-MeC27	-0.0124500	FALSE	FALSE
5	C23	-0.0118715	FALSE	FALSE
8	5-Me C23	-0.0117793	FALSE	FALSE
27	7,11-diMeC25 + 3-MeC25	-0.0116477	FALSE	FALSE
3	C23-ene	-0.0111505	FALSE	FALSE
42	4,8,14-MeC26	-0.0097947	FALSE	FALSE
57	4,8,12-triMeC28	-0.0089917	FALSE	FALSE
55	C29ene	-0.0089661	FALSE	FALSE
26	11,15-; 9,13-diMeC25	-0.0080687	FALSE	FALSE
65	3,7-; 3,9-; 3,11-diMeC29	-0.0076104	FALSE	FALSE
34	5-MeC26	-0.0066531	FALSE	FALSE
16	10,14-diMeC24	-0.0061152	FALSE	FALSE
63	C30ene	-0.0054783	FALSE	FALSE
24	7-MeC25	-0.0033031	FALSE	FALSE
53	14-; 12-; 10-MeC28	-0.0030474	FALSE	FALSE
23	9-MeC25	-0.0020305	FALSE	FALSE
47	9,17-; 9,15-diMeC27	-0.0004269	FALSE	FALSE
77	C33ene	0.0007464	FALSE	FALSE
56	C29	0.0014108	FALSE	FALSE
51	C28 + 3,15-diMeC27	0.0015377	FALSE	FALSE
20	C25	0.0019539	FALSE	FALSE
58	15-; 13-; 11-; 9-; 7-MeC29	0.0027182	FALSE	FALSE
28	5,13-diMeC25	0.0027199	FALSE	FALSE
9	9,13-diMeC23	0.0034733	FALSE	FALSE
43	13-MeC27	0.0035200	FALSE	FALSE
59	11,17-diMeC29	0.0049671	FALSE	FALSE
66	14-; 13-; 12-; 11-MeC30	0.0050449	FALSE	FALSE
48	9,13-diMeC27	0.0051735	FALSE	FALSE
4	C23-ene	0.0062418	FALSE	FALSE
52	3,9-; 3,7-diMeC27	0.0074584	FALSE	FALSE
18	C25-ene	0.0075198	FALSE	FALSE
36	10,16-; 10,14-diMeC26	0.0086021	FALSE	FALSE
72	13,19-;13,17-diMeC31	0.0093329	FALSE	FALSE
80	11,21-; 11,19-diMeC33	0.0098888	FALSE	FALSE
54	8,12,16-triMeC28	0.0103398	FALSE	FALSE
75	x-Me_C32	0.0113011	FALSE	FALSE
62	5,9-; 5,11-; 5,13-diMeC29	0.0116546	FALSE	FALSE
35	4-MeC26	0.0120883	FALSE	TRUE
30	C26	0.0127907	FALSE	TRUE

Table S1 : List of the peaks with the species identity score indicating their importance as a marker of *F. fusca* or *F. sanguinea* samples. (continued)

Peak ID	Compound	Marker score	fusca marker	sanguinea marker
79	x-Me_C32	0.0132805	FALSE	TRUE
17	C25-ene	0.0148301	FALSE	TRUE
74	(di)MeC31, mix	0.0149467	FALSE	TRUE
45	5-MeC27	0.0150032	FALSE	TRUE
46	11,15-diMeC27	0.0151218	FALSE	TRUE
76	13,17-DiMe_C32 + x,y-DiMe_C32	0.0154345	FALSE	TRUE
70	15-; 13-; 11-; 9-MeC31	0.0155745	FALSE	TRUE
71	11,19-; 11,17-; 11,15-diMeC31	0.0181955	FALSE	TRUE
38	C27-ene + 6,12-diMeC26	0.0190222	FALSE	TRUE
41	C27	0.0214514	FALSE	TRUE
67	(di)MeC30 (mix)	0.0282812	FALSE	TRUE
25	5-MeC25	0.0297436	FALSE	TRUE
50	C28ene	0.0316220	FALSE	TRUE

2.2 Species Identity Score

Ants in the mixed colonies exchanged their CHC to produce a hybrid chemical identity. We developed a method to assign each sample a value measuring similarity to one or the other species. It is based on a discriminant model that predicts the class of new samples using `predict` method from `mixOmics` R package. The input data are processed in the same way as the training set, i.e. central-log transformation is followed by projection into principal component space. In the latter step, the same rotation matrix and scaling vector is applied as those used for the training set are applied. This is achieved by using `predict` method on the object of `prcomp` class.

2.2.1 Predicted species of different categories of ants as a function of the proportion of *F. sanguinea* ants in a colony

The Species Identity Score was computed for *F. sanguinea* and *F. fusca* samples from mixed colonies and used as a response variable in linear mixed models. As a fixed effect we used the proportion of *F. sanguinea* workers among all workers in a colony. Colony ID and sampling occasion were incorporated as random effects.

In the following model specifications (1|random_factor) denotes random intercept (separate for each level of the random factor) and ((1|random_factor_1:random_factor_2)) denotes random intercepts generated from the combinations of two factors. β_0 and ϵ denote intercept and error term, respectively. Included are summary reports, results of the Shapiro-Wilk test of normalizty of conditional residuals, as well as diagnostic plots and tests generated with the use of `DHARMA` R package[Hartig, 2024]. The response variable often needed to be transformed to meet model assumptions. Random terms with no variance have been dropped.

2.2.1.1 Mature *F. sanguinea*

$$\sqrt{\text{Species_Identity_Score}} = \beta_0 + \text{sanguinea_proportion} + (1|\text{colony_ID:sampling_occasion_ID}) + \epsilon,$$

where `Species_Identity_Score` denotes the Species Identity Score of the mature *F. sanguinea* workers.

Linear mixed model fit by REML. t-tests use Satterthwaite's method ['lmerModLmerTest']

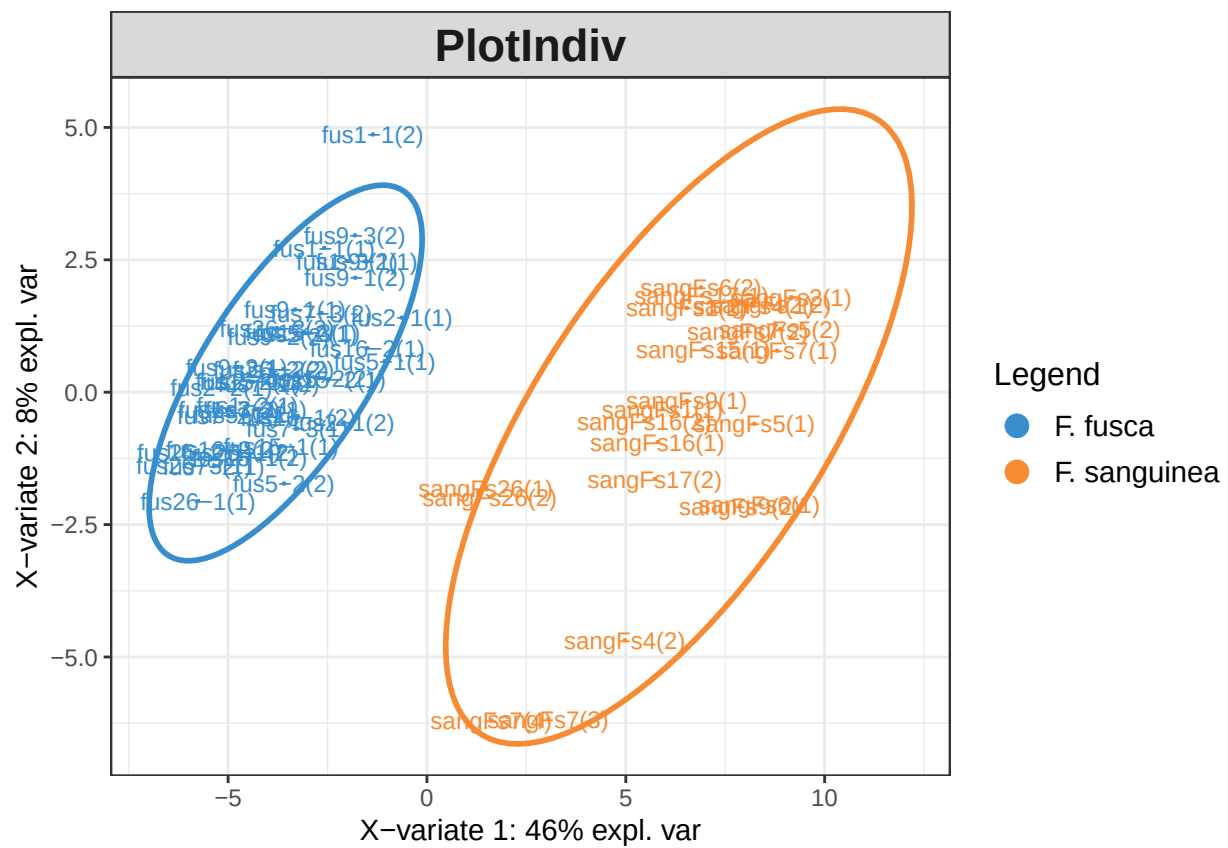


Figure S2 : Distribution of the samples projected onto two first latent components before optimizing the number of model paramaters.

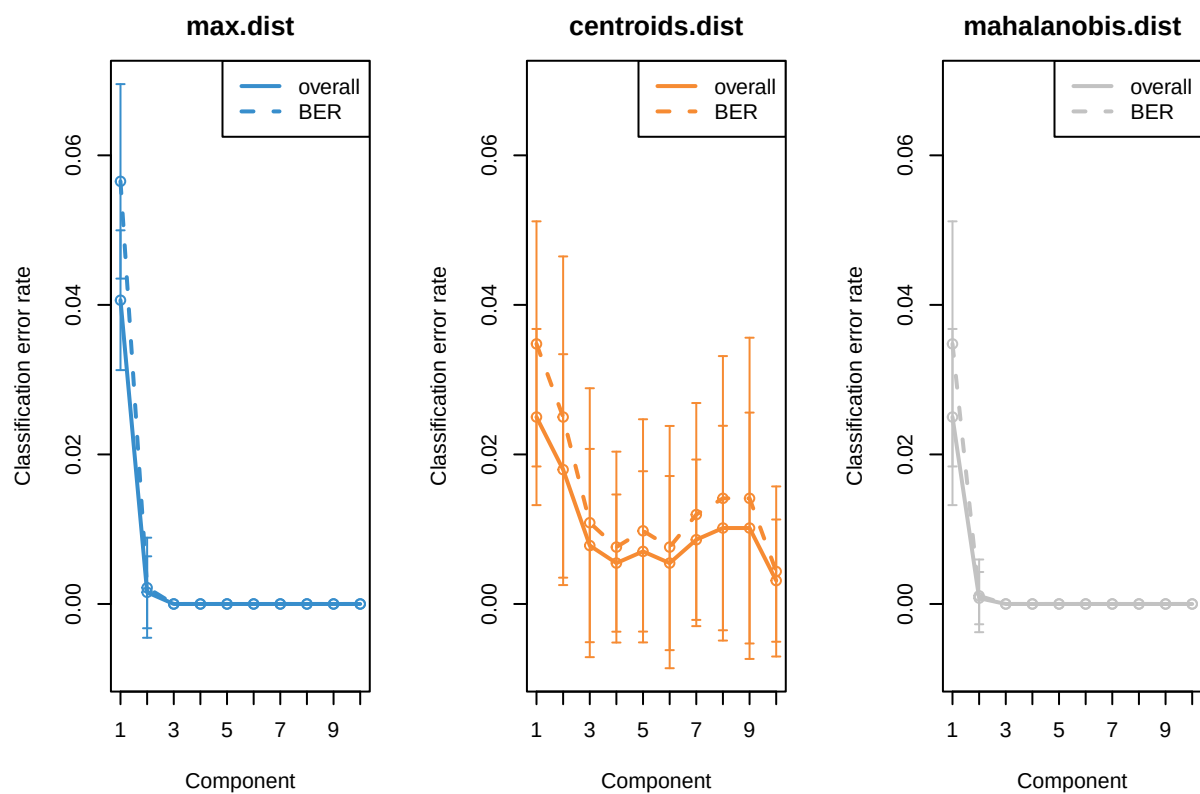


Figure S3 : Results of the performance test of the discriminant model with different number of the latent components. For details see the documunetation of R mixOmics package.

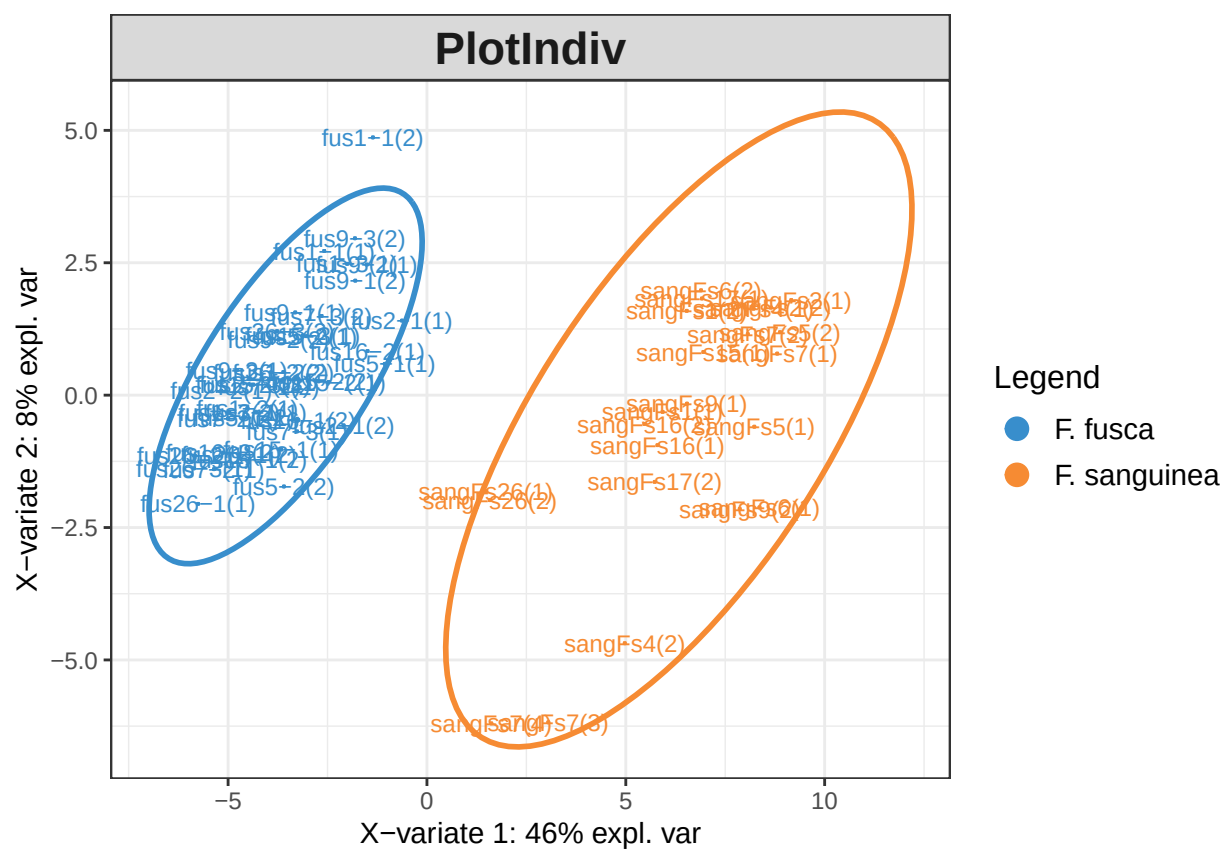


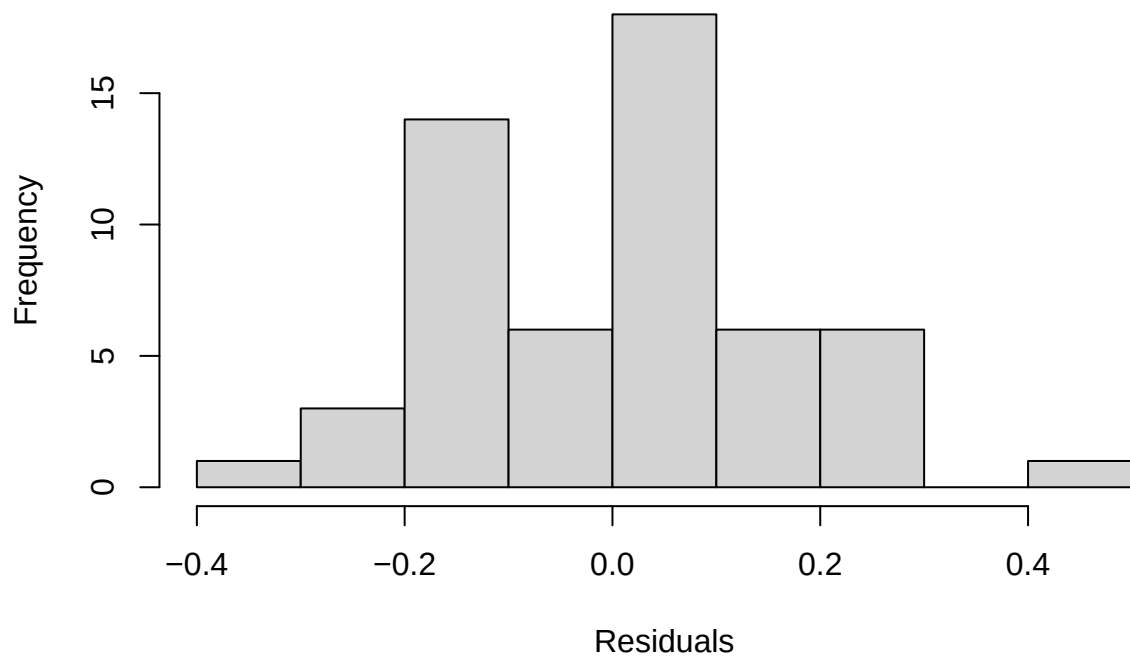
Figure S4 : Projection of the samples in onto two first discriminant analysis components after model tuning.

```

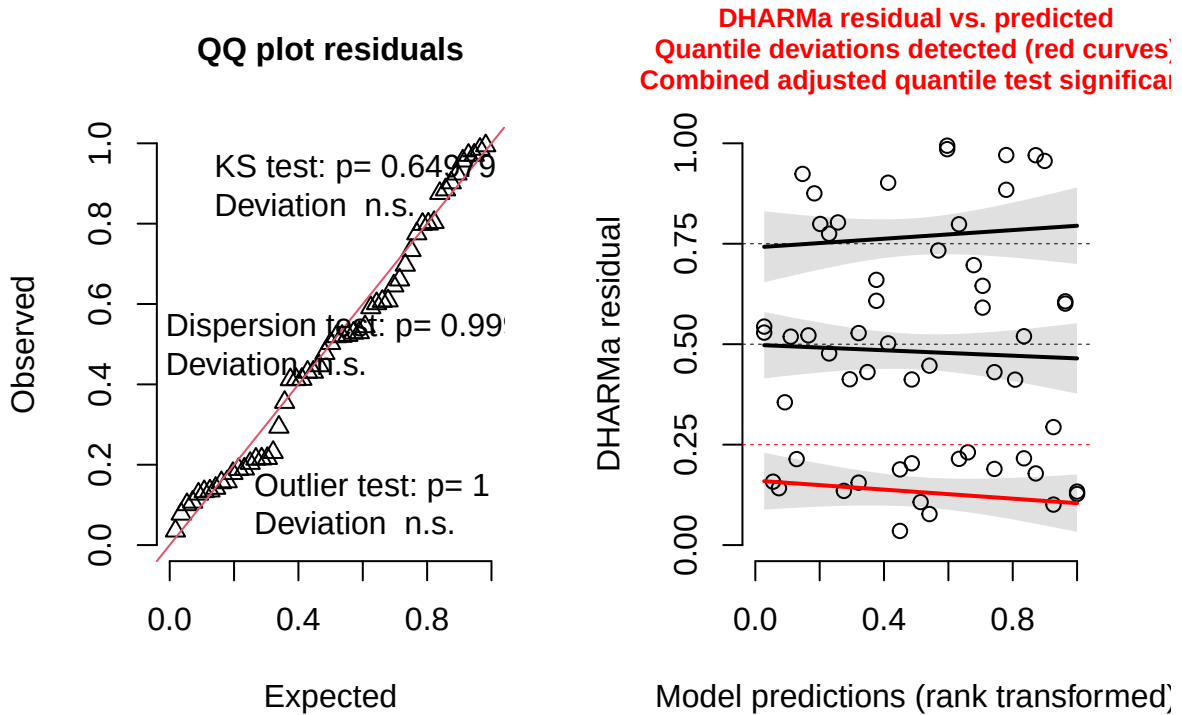
## Formula: I(sqrt(predicted_species)) ~ sang_prop + (1 | colony:census_date)
## Data: model_input
##
## REML criterion at convergence: 15.1
##
## Scaled residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -1.67059 -0.70651  0.03909  0.45140  2.13865
##
## Random effects:
## Groups           Name          Variance Std.Dev.
## colony:census_date (Intercept) 0.03547  0.1883
## Residual              0.04090  0.2022
## Number of obs: 55, groups: colony:census_date, 38
##
## Fixed effects:
##              Estimate Std. Error    df t value Pr(>|t|)
## (Intercept)  0.70476    0.07965 40.25725   8.849 5.49e-11 ***
## sang_prop    1.02077    0.14311 37.99116   7.133 1.63e-08 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## Correlation of Fixed Effects:
##              (Intr)
## sang_prop -0.853
##
##
## Shapiro-Wilk normality test
##
## data: residuals(lm_model)
## W = 0.98367, p-value = 0.657

```

Model conditional residuals



DHARMA residual



2.2.1.2 *F. fusca*

Species_Identity_Score = $\beta_0 + \text{sanguinea_proportion} + (1|\text{colony}) + (1|\text{colony_ID:sampling_occasion_ID}) + \epsilon$,

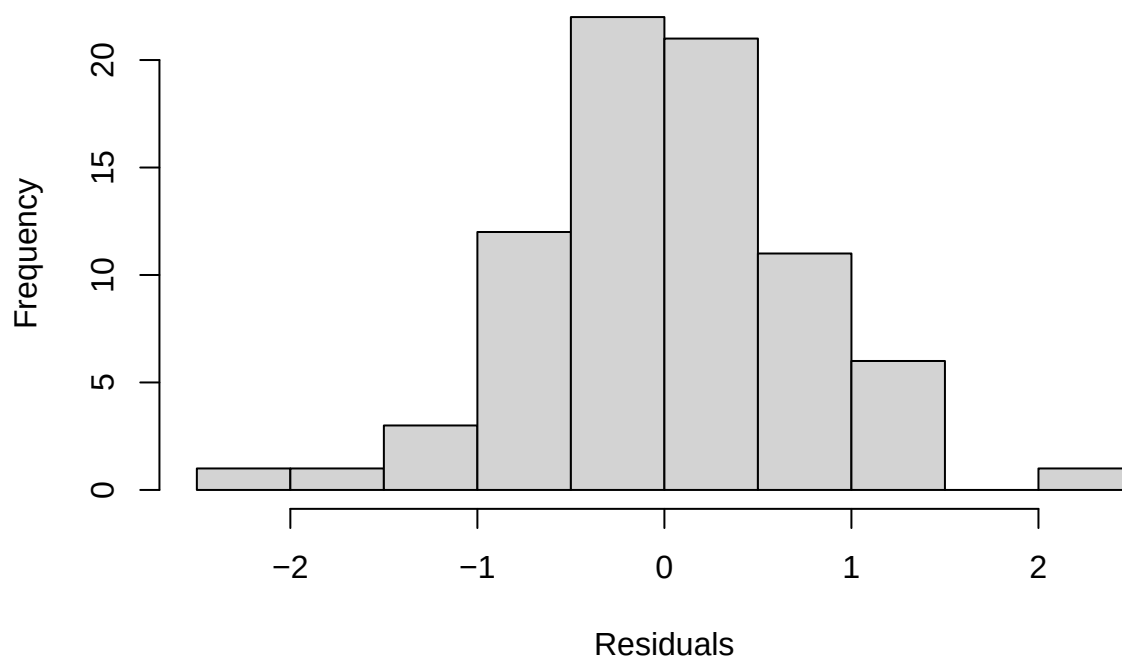
where Species_Identity_Score denotes the Species Identity Score of the mature *F. fusca* workers.

```
## Linear mixed model fit by REML. t-tests use Satterthwaite's method ['lmerModLmerTest']
## Formula: predicted_species ~ sang_prop + (1 | colony) + (1 | colony:census_date)
## Data: model_input
##
## REML criterion at convergence: 230.1
##
## Scaled residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -2.84293 -0.49799 -0.00101  0.51466  2.30723
##
## Random effects:
## Groups              Name            Variance Std.Dev.
## colony:census_date (Intercept) 0.2786    0.5278
## colony              (Intercept) 0.1613    0.4016
## Residual                        0.7560    0.8695
## Number of obs: 78, groups: colony:census_date, 55; colony, 20
##
## Fixed effects:
##              Estimate Std. Error      df t value Pr(>|t|)
```

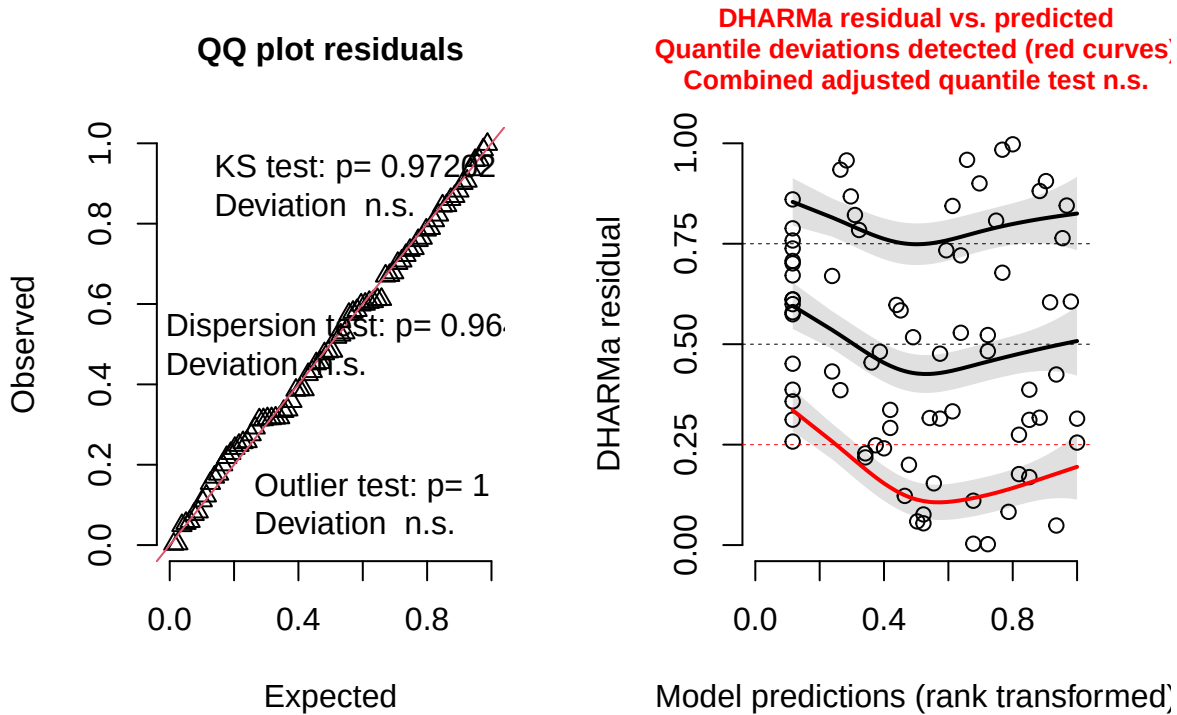
```
## (Intercept)  -1.1567      0.2046 41.7318  -5.653 1.28e-06 ***
## sang_prop    3.4941      0.4413 37.9240   7.917 1.48e-09 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## Correlation of Fixed Effects:
##      (Intr)
## sang_prop -0.648

##
## Shapiro-Wilk normality test
##
## data:  residuals(lm_model)
## W = 0.98191, p-value = 0.3341
```

Model conditional residuals



DHARMa residual



2.2.1.3 Callow *F. sanguinea*

$$\text{Species_Identity_Score} = \beta_0 + \text{sanguinea_proportion} + (1|\text{colony}) + \epsilon,$$

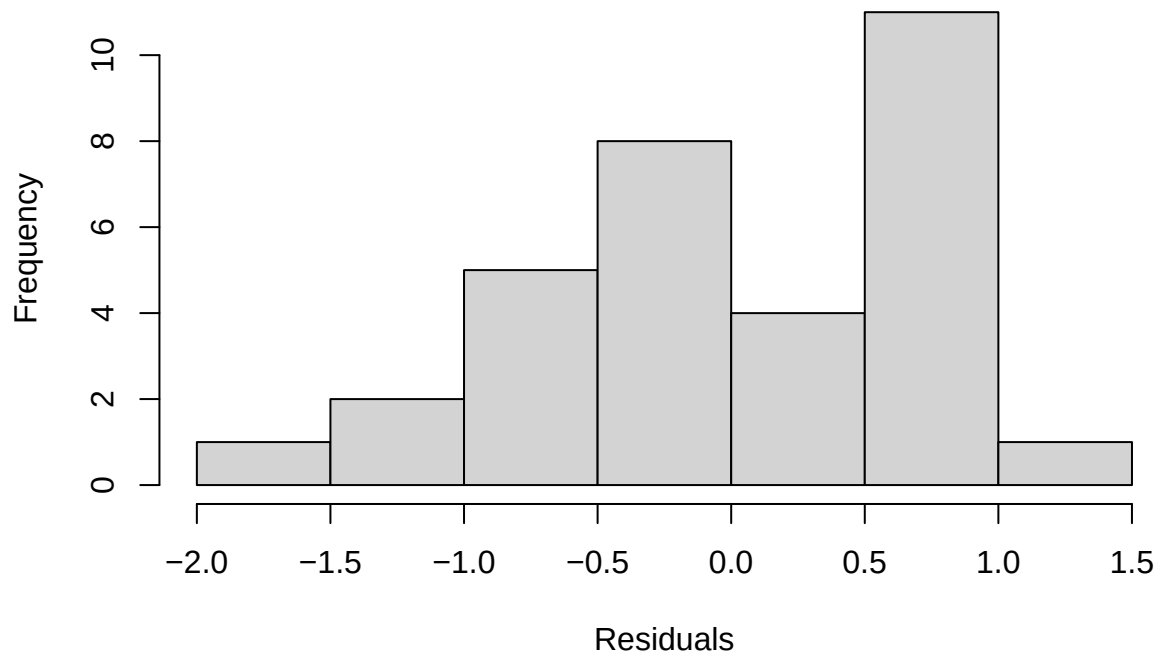
where Species_Identity_Score denotes the Species Identity Score of the callow *F. sanguinea* workers.

```
## Linear mixed model fit by REML. t-tests use Satterthwaite's method ['lmerModLmerTest']
## Formula: predicted_species ~ sang_prop + (1 | colony)
## Data: model_input
##
## REML criterion at convergence: 76.1
##
## Scaled residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -2.02656 -0.63913 -0.06358  0.80146  1.76498
##
## Random effects:
## Groups Name Variance Std.Dev.
## colony (Intercept) 0.08451 0.2907
## Residual 0.56151 0.7493
## Number of obs: 32, groups: colony, 16
##
## Fixed effects:
## Estimate Std. Error df t value Pr(>|t|)
## (Intercept) -0.5935 0.2554 28.9222 -2.324 0.0274 *
```

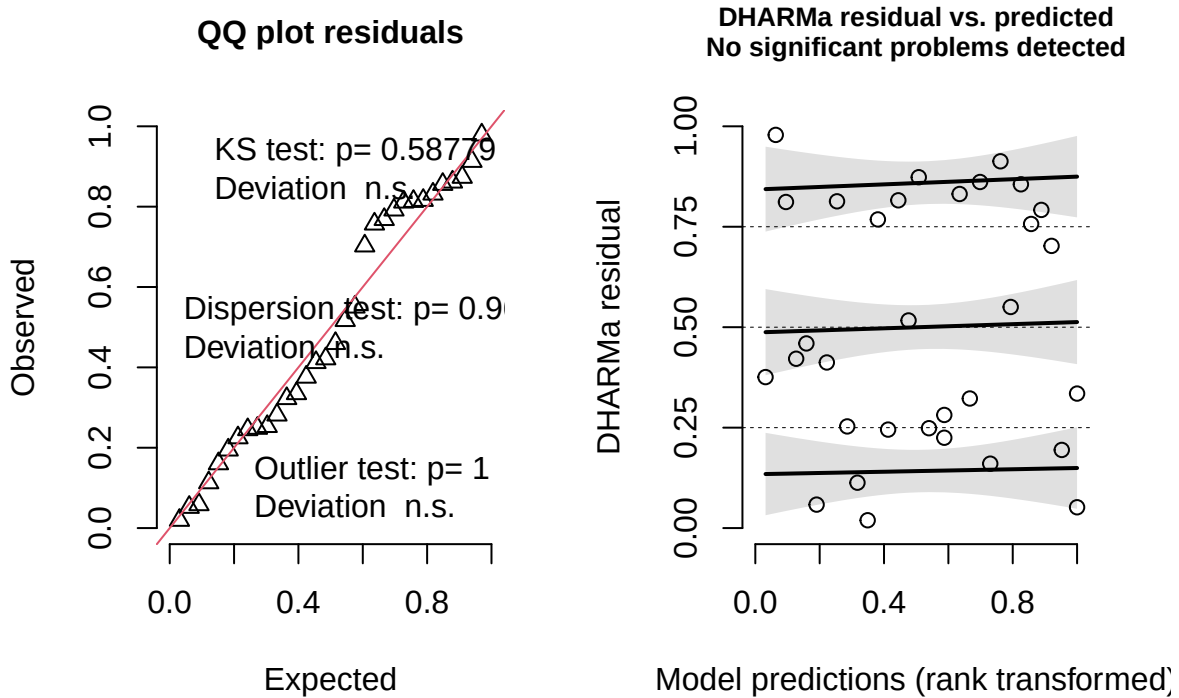
```
## sang_prop      2.4749      0.4663 28.3415   5.308 1.15e-05 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## Correlation of Fixed Effects:
##      (Intr)
## sang_prop -0.798

##
## Shapiro-Wilk normality test
##
## data:  residuals(lm_model)
## W = 0.97007, p-value = 0.5014
```

Model conditional residuals



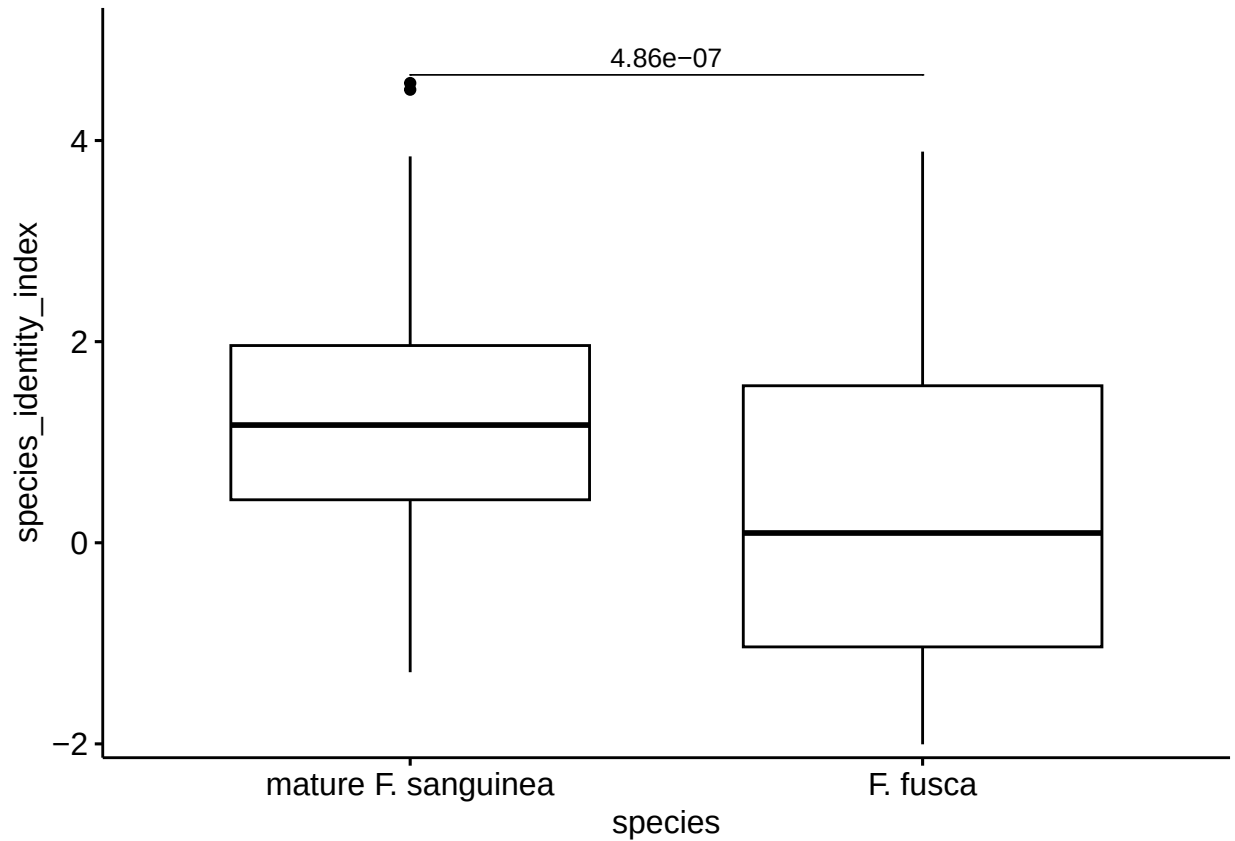
DHARMA residual



2.2.2 Difference in Species Identity Score between mature *F. sanguinea* ants and *F. fusca* slaves

Since the linear model does not meet one of diagnostics criteria, a Wilcoxon paired test was applied.

```
##
## Wilcoxon signed rank test with continuity correction
##
## data: model_input$predicted_species and model_input$slave_species_index
## V = 1843, p-value = 4.856e-07
## alternative hypothesis: true location shift is not equal to 0
```



2.2.3 Difference in Species Identity Score between callow *F. sanguinea* ants and *F. fusca* slaves

$$\text{SIS_diff} = \beta_0 + \text{sanguinea_proportion} + (1|\text{colony}) + \epsilon,$$

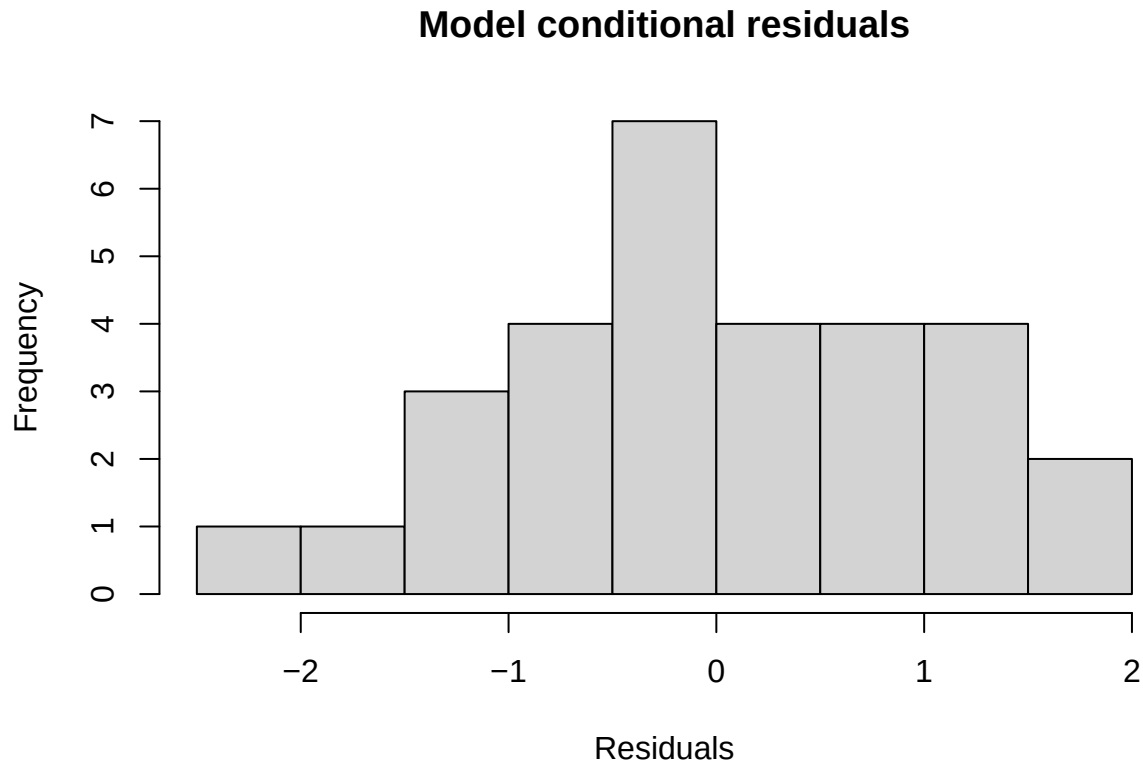
where SIS_diff denotes the difference in Species Identity Score between the mature *F. sanguinea* and *F. fusca* sampled at the same time and from the same colony. Replicated samples were averaged before the calculations.

Since the linear model does not meet one of diagnostics criterion we will apply Wilcoxon paired test.

```
##
## Call:
## lm(formula = index_diff ~ sang_prop, data = model_input)
##
## Residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -2.4185 -0.6058 -0.1187  0.7012  1.7033
##
## Coefficients:
##              Estimate Std. Error t value Pr(>|t|)
## (Intercept)   0.4099     0.3321   1.234   0.227
## sang_prop    -0.6889     0.6849  -1.006   0.323
##
## Residual standard error: 1.013 on 28 degrees of freedom
## (2 observations deleted due to missingness)
```

```
## Multiple R-squared:  0.03488,    Adjusted R-squared:  0.0004127
## F-statistic: 1.012 on 1 and 28 DF,  p-value: 0.323

##
##  Shapiro-Wilk normality test
##
## data:  residuals(lm_model)
## W = 0.97214, p-value = 0.5992
```

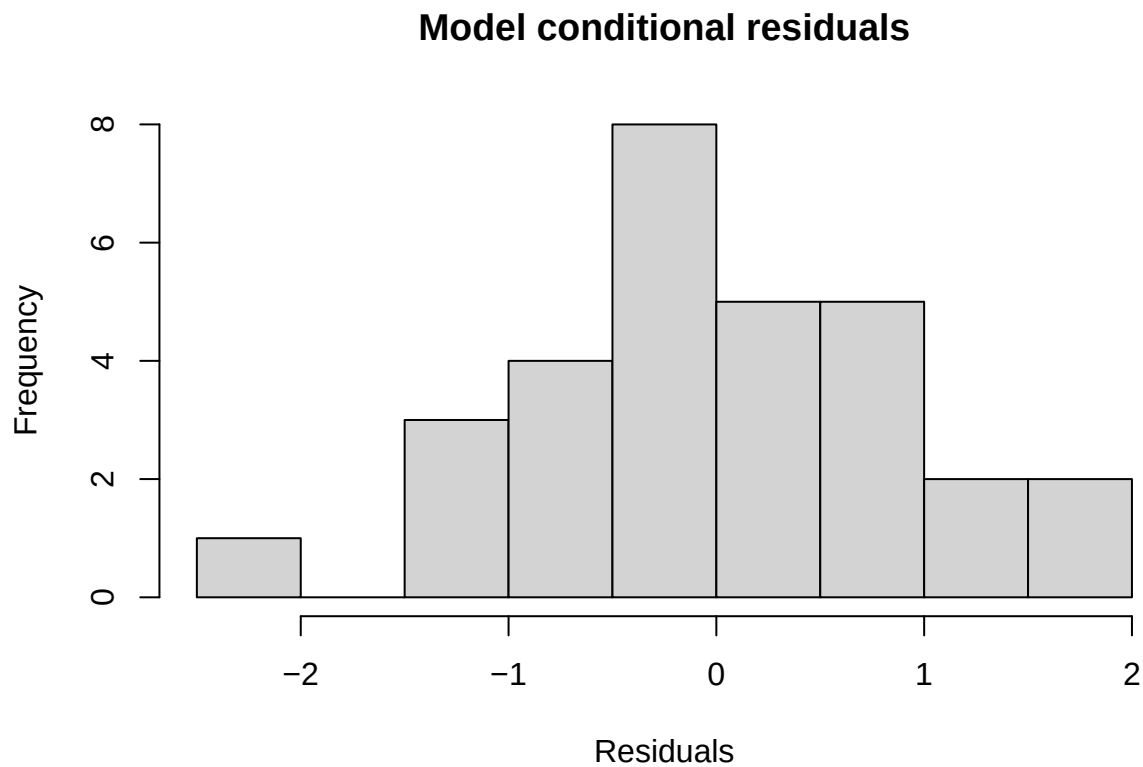


2.2.4 Difference in Species Identity Score between callow and mature *F. sanguinea* ants.

```
##
## Call:
## lm(formula = index_diff ~ sang_prop, data = model_input)
##
## Residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -2.31963 -0.51182 -0.08442  0.67933  1.85442
##
## Coefficients:
##              Estimate Std. Error t value Pr(>|t|)
## (Intercept)  -0.7008     0.3147  -2.227  0.0342 *
## sang_prop    -0.1707     0.5758  -0.297  0.7690
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
```

```
##
## Residual standard error: 0.9399 on 28 degrees of freedom
## (2 observations deleted due to missingness)
## Multiple R-squared: 0.003131, Adjusted R-squared: -0.03247
## F-statistic: 0.08793 on 1 and 28 DF, p-value: 0.769

##
## Shapiro-Wilk normality test
##
## data: residuals(lm_model)
## W = 0.98622, p-value = 0.9561
```



3 Finding peaks differentiating callow and mature *F. sanguinea* workers

The procedure identifying species markers was also applied to determine peaks characteristic of *F. sanguinea* callow ants. In discriminant analysis, samples were classified into one of the three groups: callow *F. sanguinea*, adult *F. sanguinea*, or adult *F. fusca*.

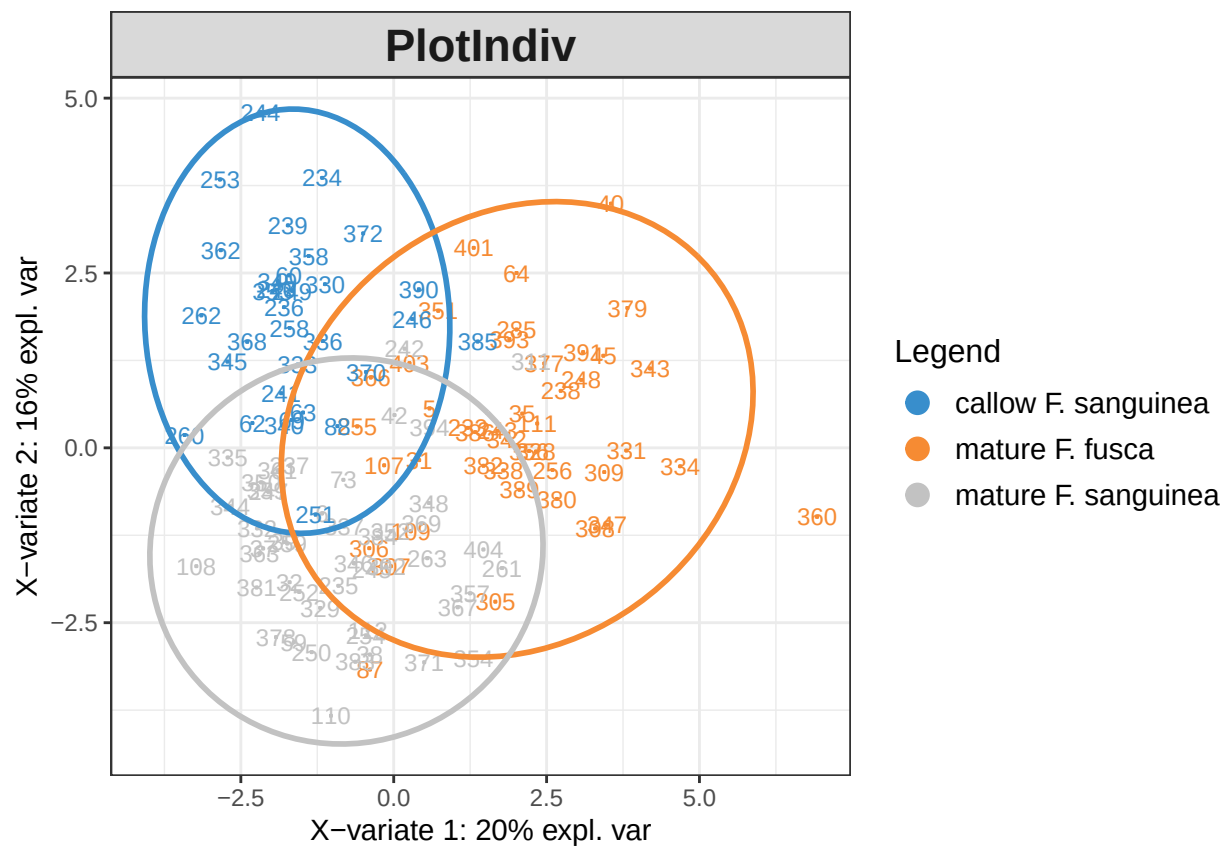


Figure S5 : Distribution of the samples projected onto two first latent components before optimizing the number of model paramaters.

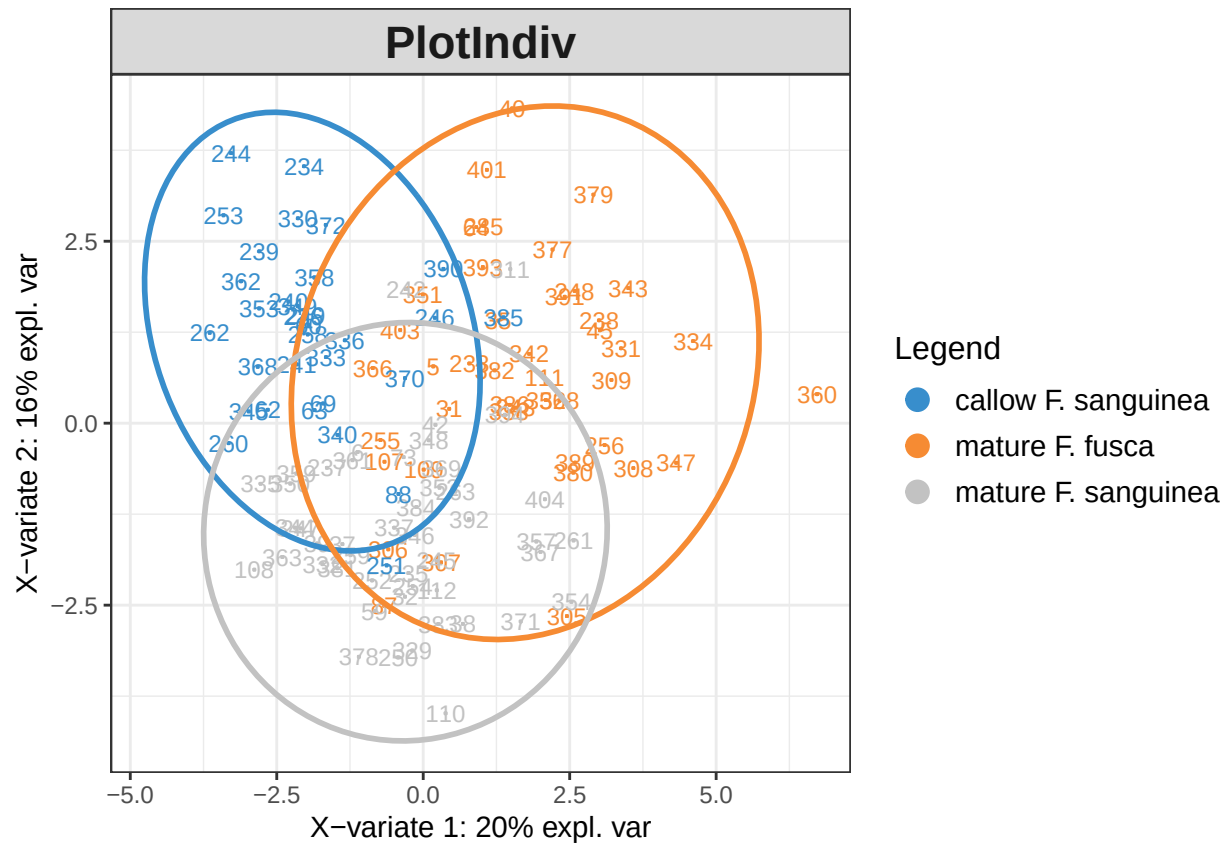


Figure S6 : Projection of the samples in onto two first discriminant analysis components after model tuning.

Table S2 : List of the peaks with the score indicating their importance as a marker of mature *F. fusca*, mature *F. sanguinea*, or callow *F. sanguinea* samples.

Peak ID	Compound	Callow score	Callow marker	Mature score	Mature marker
68	C31ene; 3-MeC30	0.1130847	TRUE	-0.0902940	FALSE
77	C33ene	0.0674065	TRUE	-0.0358531	FALSE
43	13-MeC27	0.0660307	TRUE	-0.0176578	FALSE
32	14-; 10-MeC26 + 3,7,11-triMeC25	0.0566271	TRUE	-0.0470084	FALSE
53	14-; 12-; 10-MeC28	0.0548579	TRUE	-0.0275054	FALSE
58	15-; 13-; 11-; 9-; 7-MeC29	0.0489691	TRUE	0.0004851	FALSE
22	13-; 11-; 9-MeC25	0.0448772	TRUE	-0.0571426	FALSE
13	12-; 11-; 10-; 9-; 8-MeC24	0.0364630	TRUE	-0.0599463	FALSE
28	5,13-diMeC25	0.0280841	TRUE	-0.0276607	FALSE
19	4,12-diMeC24	0.0279189	TRUE	-0.0536605	FALSE
31	3,13-diMeC25	0.0277922	TRUE	-0.0257284	FALSE
66	14-; 13-; 12-; 11-MeC30	0.0263989	TRUE	-0.0202339	FALSE
38	C27-ene + 6,12-diMeC26	0.0261492	FALSE	0.0197898	FALSE
24	7-MeC25	0.0255483	FALSE	-0.0057152	FALSE
10	3-MeC23	0.0234896	FALSE	-0.0308856	FALSE
64	C30	0.0187834	FALSE	-0.0368979	FALSE
5	C23	0.0179810	FALSE	-0.0306055	FALSE
45	5-MeC27	0.0155024	FALSE	0.0260230	FALSE
52	3,9-; 3,7-diMeC27	0.0102577	FALSE	-0.0312129	FALSE
71	11,19-; 11,17-; 11,15-diMeC31	0.0093526	FALSE	0.0435967	TRUE
6	11-Me-C23 + 9-Me-C23	0.0092063	FALSE	-0.0222486	FALSE
12	3,13-; 3,11-; 3,9-; 3,7-diMeC23	0.0089605	FALSE	-0.0218476	FALSE
70	15-; 13-; 11-; 9-MeC31	0.0086096	FALSE	0.0291918	FALSE
78	x-Me-C32	0.0059607	FALSE	-0.0253181	FALSE
79	x-Me_C32	0.0046869	FALSE	0.0085653	FALSE
50	C28ene	0.0035810	FALSE	0.0362238	TRUE
49	7,11-diMeC27	0.0035568	FALSE	-0.0346106	FALSE
56	C29	0.0014290	FALSE	-0.0378337	FALSE
60	13,17-diMeC29	0.0009481	FALSE	0.0151416	FALSE
26	11,15-; 9,13-diMeC25	-0.0038959	FALSE	-0.0078690	FALSE
47	9,17-; 9,15-diMeC27	-0.0041782	FALSE	-0.0065953	FALSE
27	7,11-diMeC25 + 3-MeC25	-0.0043027	FALSE	0.0375409	TRUE
23	9-MeC25	-0.0046829	FALSE	0.0219543	FALSE
36	10,16-; 10,14-diMeC26	-0.0065927	FALSE	0.0077764	FALSE
75	x-Me_C32	-0.0078838	FALSE	0.0041896	FALSE
30	C26	-0.0083596	FALSE	-0.0016878	FALSE
37	7,x-; 5,x-; 10,14-diMeC26	-0.0117943	FALSE	-0.0474630	FALSE
54	8,12,16-triMeC28	-0.0124810	FALSE	0.0268892	FALSE
3	C23-ene	-0.0161920	FALSE	-0.0380185	FALSE
11	C24	-0.0176539	FALSE	-0.0210220	FALSE
46	11,15-diMeC27	-0.0244479	FALSE	0.0612482	TRUE
25	5-MeC25	-0.0245862	FALSE	0.0606407	TRUE
51	C28 + 3,15-diMeC27	-0.0247170	FALSE	0.0199851	FALSE
20	C25	-0.0251803	FALSE	-0.0101043	FALSE
61	7,11-; 7,13-; 7,15-diMeC29	-0.0255085	FALSE	0.0354476	TRUE

Table S2 : List of the peaks with the score indicating their importance as a marker of mature *F. fusca*, mature *F. sanguinea*, or callow *F. sanguinea* samples. (continued)

Peak ID	Compound	Callow score	Callow marker	Mature score	Mature marker
48	9,13-diMeC27	-0.0262900	FALSE	0.0347272	TRUE
7	7-Me-C23	-0.0265325	FALSE	-0.0002857	FALSE
17	C25-ene	-0.0284637	FALSE	0.0614603	TRUE
67	(di)MeC30 (mix)	-0.0289253	FALSE	0.0555200	TRUE
59	11,17-diMeC29	-0.0321720	FALSE	0.0333428	FALSE
44	7-MeC27	-0.0322311	FALSE	-0.0112348	FALSE
72	13,19-;13,17-diMeC31	-0.0362628	FALSE	0.0083934	FALSE
80	11,21-; 11,19-diMeC33	-0.0391225	FALSE	0.0484717	TRUE
69	C31	-0.0458503	FALSE	-0.0094236	FALSE
76	13,17-DiMe_C32 + x,y-DiMe_C32	-0.0677400	FALSE	0.0968633	TRUE
41	C27	-0.0689956	FALSE	0.0381717	TRUE

3.1 Verifying the performance of the discrimination model

The performance of the discriminant model was evaluated by examining the accuracy of its predictions in a cross-validation test, measured as the area under the receiver operating characteristic curve (AUROC). This procedure was repeated 10^3 times to account for variance resulting from the random splitting of samples into training and validation sets. In a parallel analysis, the model was trained on data with permuted age status of *F. sanguinea* to assess whether the true assignment of samples influenced model performance. Results from both training approaches were paired, and the difference in AUROC was calculated each for pair. The empirical p-value was defined as the proportion of models in which the AUROC after permutation was equal to or greater than the AUROC based on the original data.

The p-value is calculated as proportion of differences with value equal to or less than zero.

All differences are positive, so the p-value is less than 0.001 since the null distribution consists of 1000 values.

4 Changes of CHC amount over time

This section contains a series of linear (mixed) models fitted to examine how the proportion of *F. sanguinea* workers in a colony is associated with the amount of CHC, analyzed as a whole or in subsets. Included are summary reports, results of the Shapiro-Wilk test of normality of conditional residuals, as well as diagnostic plots and tests generated with the use of **DHARMA** R package[Hartig, 2024]. The response variable often needed to be transformed to meet model assumptions. Random terms with no variance have been dropped.

In model specification (1|random_factor) denotes random intercept (separate for each level of the random factor) and ((1|random_factor_1:random_factor_2)) denotes random intercepts generated from the combinations of two factors. β_0 and ϵ denote intercept and error term, respectively.

4.1 Colony growth and body size

In the analyses below, the normalized CHC amounts were used as a response variable. Since the body shape in both species deviates from isometric growth pattern (see Section @ref(surface_area)), the CHC amount normalization by the square of head width might bias the calculations. To account for that we first examine the relationship between body size (head width) and proportion of *F. sanguinea* worker in a colony and next we incorporate the square of head width as an explanatory variable to the linear model.

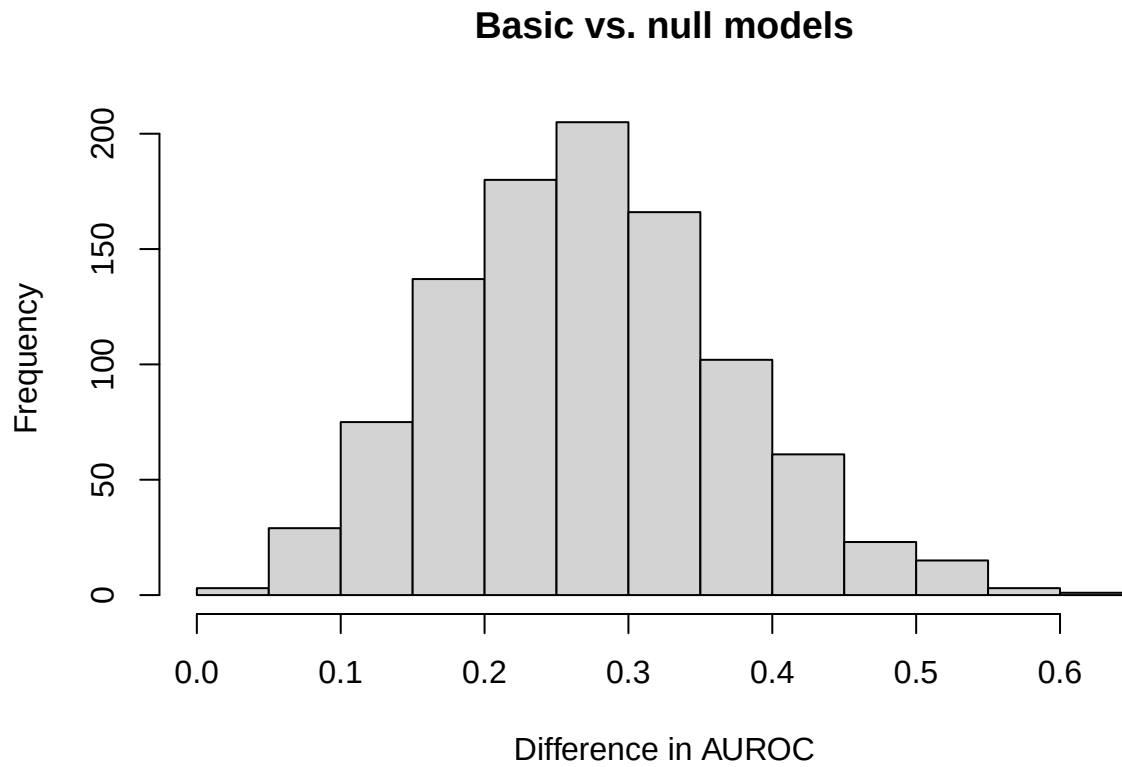
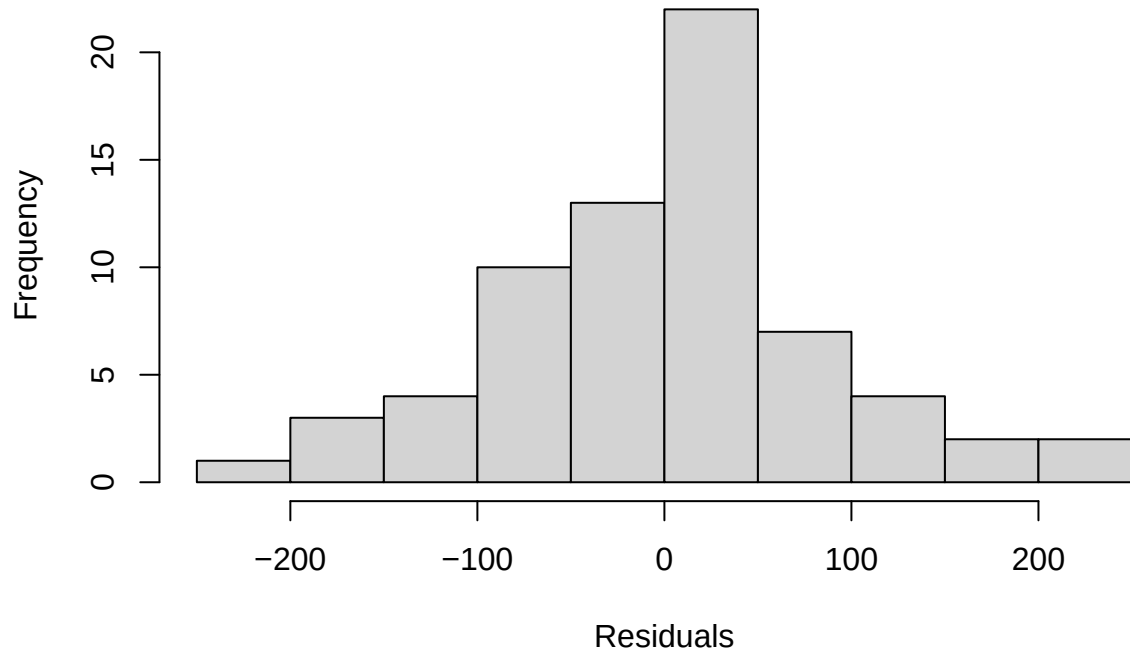


Figure S7 : Distribution of the differences in the performance of the discriminant models trained on true and permuted data. Age status of *F. sanguinea* ants were shuffled in the null variant.

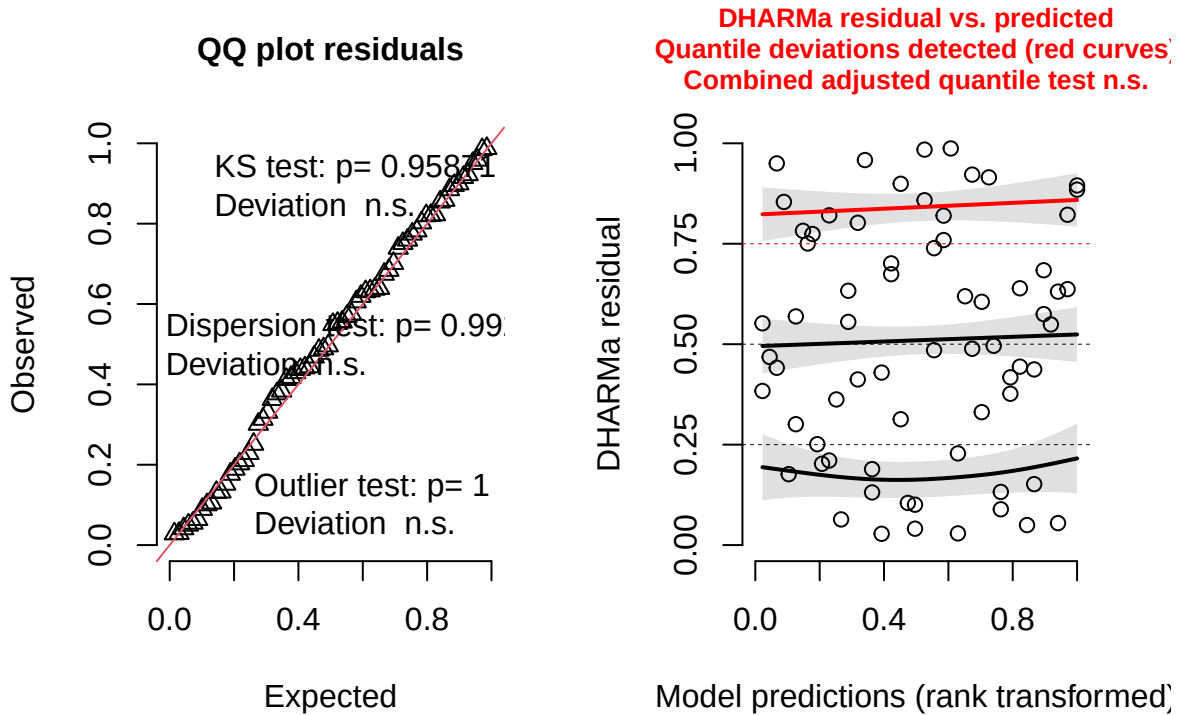
$$\text{head_width} = \beta_0 + \text{sanguinea_proportion} + (1|\text{colony_ID}) + \epsilon,$$

```
## Linear mixed model fit by REML. t-tests use Satterthwaite's method ['lmerModLmerTest']
## Formula: head_width ~ sang_prop + (1 | colony)
## Data: model_input
##
## REML criterion at convergence: 808
##
## Scaled residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -2.10138 -0.61076  0.06058  0.43106  2.28980
##
## Random effects:
##  Groups   Name                Variance Std.Dev.
## colony   (Intercept)          3155     56.17
## Residual                    9110     95.45
## Number of obs: 68, groups: colony, 16
##
## Fixed effects:
##              Estimate Std. Error    df t value Pr(>|t|)
## (Intercept)  1218.06      26.41   38.93  46.121 < 2e-16 ***
## sang_prop     125.14      43.44   62.10   2.881  0.00544 **
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## Correlation of Fixed Effects:
##              (Intr)
## sang_prop -0.715
##
## Shapiro-Wilk normality test
##
## data: residuals(lm_model)
## W = 0.9861, p-value = 0.6514
```

Model conditional residuals



DHARMa residual



4.2 Change in the total CHCs mass

In this series of models the total CHC mass (normalized by assuming head width of 1.3 mm) was regressed on the proportion of *Formica sanguinea* workers in the colony.

4.2.1 Mature *F. sanguinea*

$\log(\text{CHC_mass_sanguinea}) = \beta_0 + \text{sanguinea_proportion} + (\text{head_width})^2 + (1 | \text{colony_ID}) + (1 | \text{colony_ID} : \text{sampling_occasion})$

where CHC_mass_sanguinea denotes the total normalized CHC mass on the body of adult *F. sanguinea* worker.

```
## Linear mixed model fit by REML. t-tests use Satterthwaite's method ['lmerModLmerTest']
## Formula: I(log(corrected_mass)) ~ sang_prop + I(head_width^2) + (1 | colony) +
## (1 | colony:census_date)
## Data: model_input
##
## REML criterion at convergence: 120.5
##
## Scaled residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -1.71434 -0.36455  0.00409  0.49864  1.78352
##
## Random effects:
##  Groups      Name      Variance Std.Dev.
```

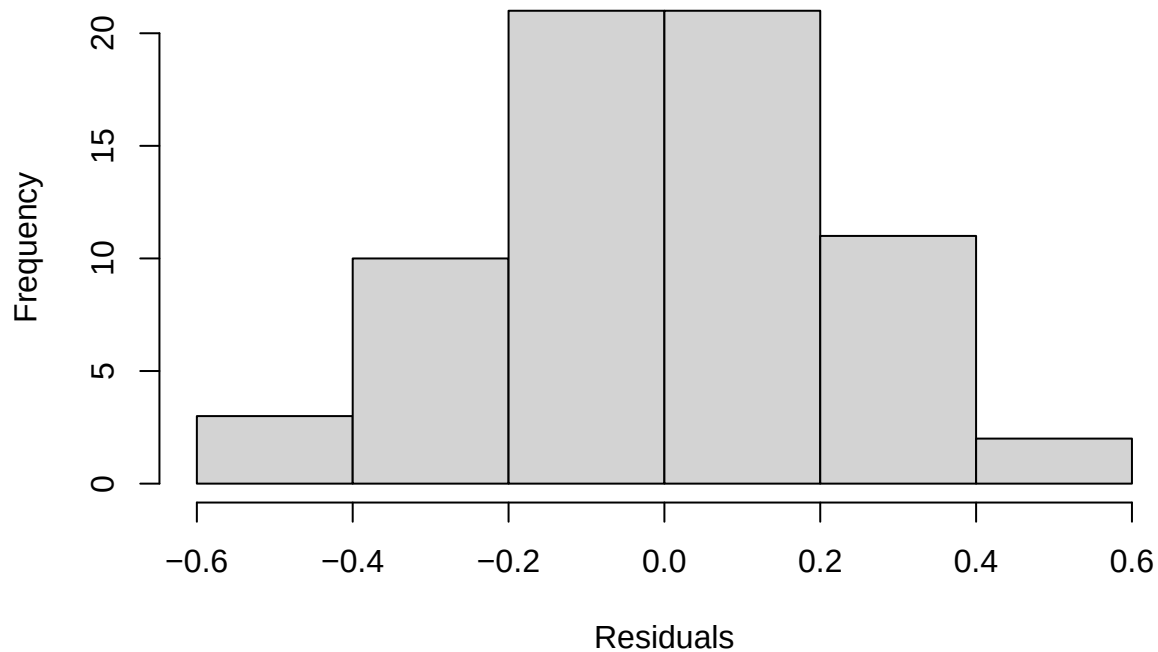
```

## colony:census_date (Intercept) 0.12525 0.3539
## colony (Intercept) 0.03448 0.1857
## Residual 0.10396 0.3224
## Number of obs: 68, groups: colony:census_date, 44; colony, 16
##
## Fixed effects:
## Estimate Std. Error df t value Pr(>|t|)
## (Intercept) 1.215e+00 3.429e-01 6.384e+01 3.544 0.000744 ***
## sang_prop 8.476e-01 2.506e-01 3.901e+01 3.382 0.001646 **
## I(head_width^2) -2.012e-07 2.134e-07 6.167e+01 -0.943 0.349440
## ---
## Signif. codes: 0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## Correlation of Fixed Effects:
## (Intr) sng_pr
## sang_prop 0.000
## I(hd_wdt^2) -0.924 -0.305
## fit warnings:
## Some predictor variables are on very different scales: consider rescaling

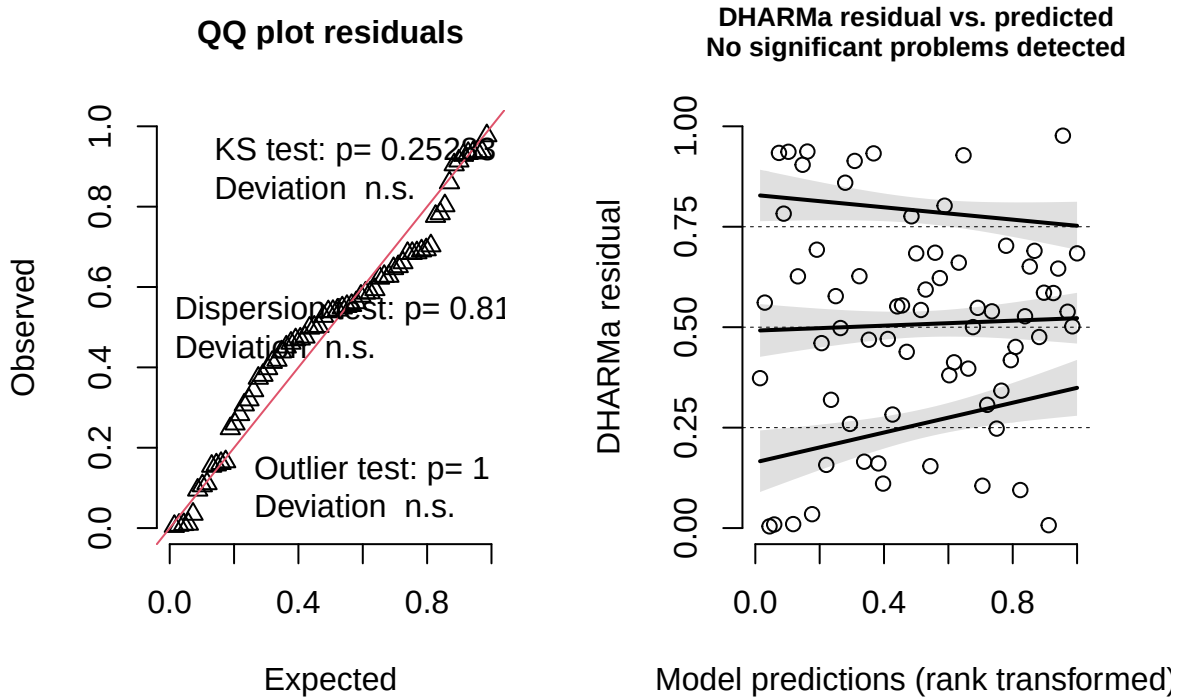
##
## Shapiro-Wilk normality test
##
## data: residuals(lm_model)
## W = 0.98867, p-value = 0.798

```

Model conditional residuals



DHARMA residual



The model shows no significant effect of body size on CHC amount in *F. sanguinea*, and this term will therefore be excluded from subsequent models for this species.

4.2.2 *F. fusca*

$$\log(\text{CHC_mass_fusca}) = \beta_0 + \text{sanguinea_proportion} + (\text{head_width})^2 + (1|\text{colony_ID}) + \epsilon,$$

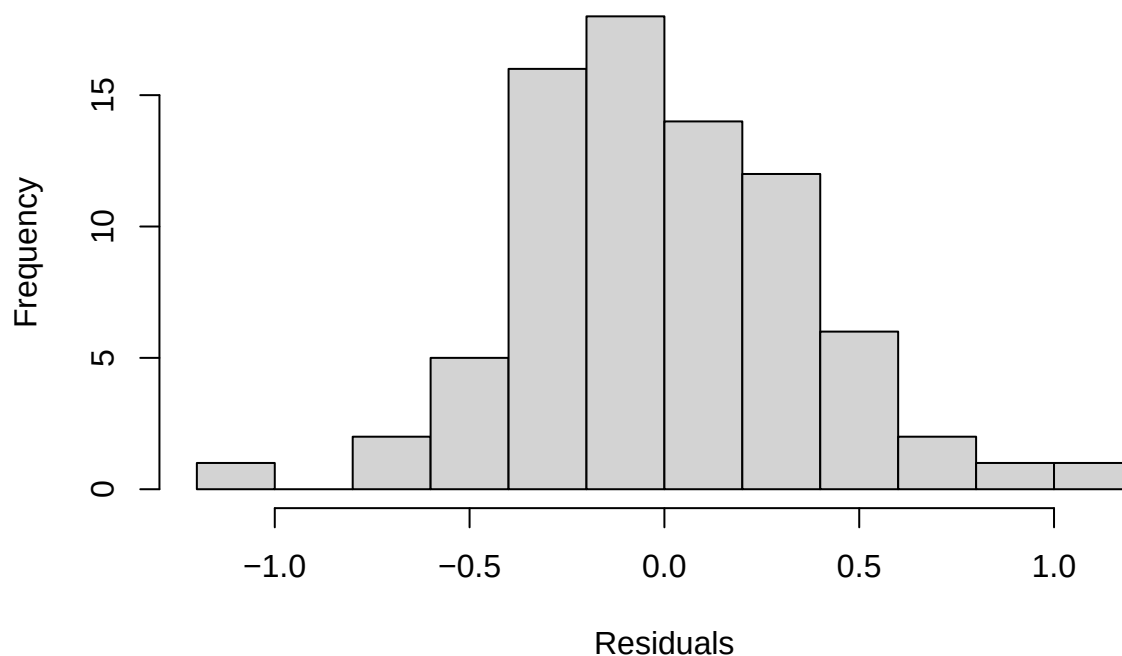
where CHC_mass_fusca denotes the total normalized CHC mass on the body of adult *F. fusca* worker.

```
## Linear mixed model fit by REML. t-tests use Satterthwaite's method ['lmerModLmerTest']
## Formula: I(log(corrected_mass)) ~ sang_prop + I(head_width^2) + (1 | colony)
## Data: model_input
##
## REML criterion at convergence: 127.1
##
## Scaled residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -2.7162 -0.5731 -0.1218  0.5782  2.4978
##
## Random effects:
##  Groups   Name                Variance Std.Dev.
## colony   (Intercept)  0.05605   0.2367
## Residual                    0.16466   0.4058
## Number of obs: 78, groups: colony, 20
##
```

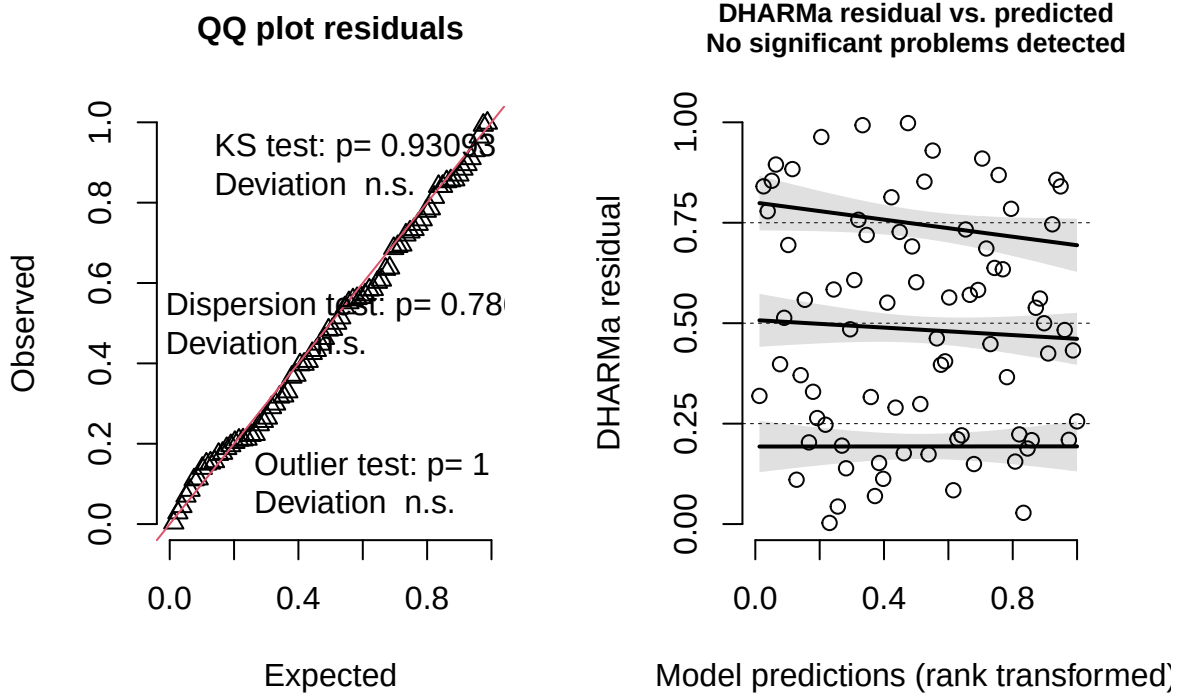
```
## Fixed effects:
##               Estimate Std. Error      df t value Pr(>|t|)
## (Intercept)    1.512e+00  3.851e-01  5.802e+01   3.926 0.000232 ***
## sang_prop      2.627e-01  1.738e-01  6.883e+01   1.511 0.135262
## I(head_width^2) -8.355e-07  3.270e-07  5.972e+01  -2.555 0.013192 *
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## Correlation of Fixed Effects:
##           (Intr) sng_pr
## sang_prop    0.077
## I(hd_wdt^2) -0.974 -0.210
## fit warnings:
## Some predictor variables are on very different scales: consider rescaling

##
## Shapiro-Wilk normality test
##
## data:  residuals(lm_model)
## W = 0.99146, p-value = 0.8874
```

Model conditional residuals



DHARMa residual



4.2.3 Callow *F. sanguinea*

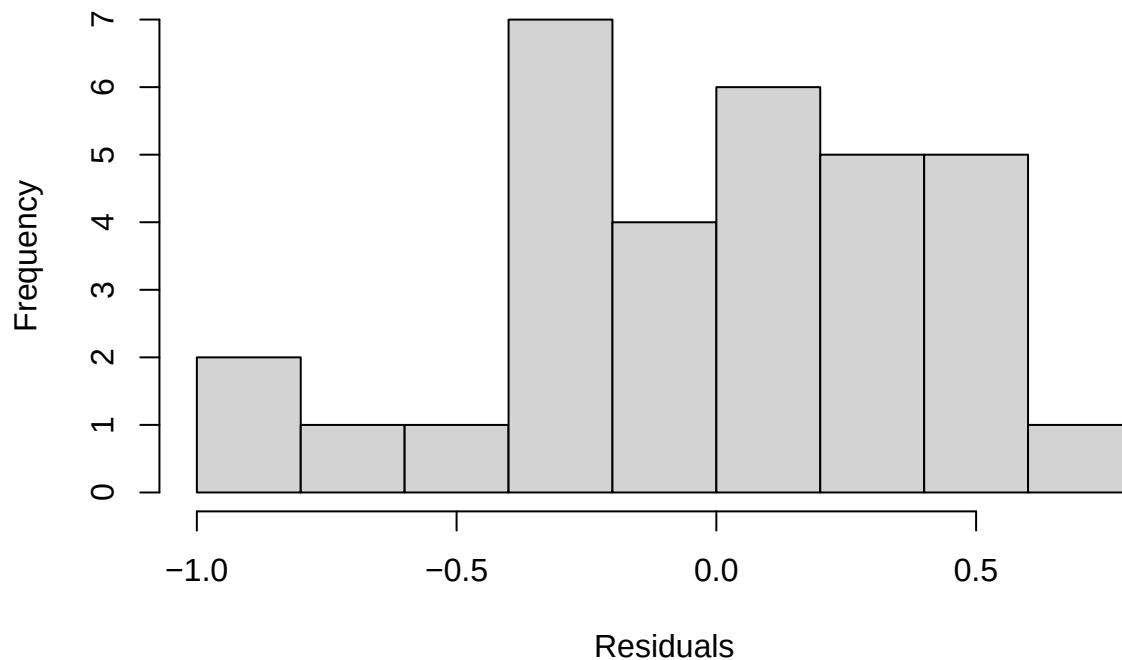
$\log(\text{CHC_mass_callow}) = \beta_0 + \text{sanguinea_proportion} + (1|\text{colony_ID}) + (1|\text{colony_ID}:\text{sampling_occasion_ID}) + \epsilon$,
where CHC_mass_callow denotes the total normalized CHC mass on the body of callow *F. sanguinea* worker.

```
## Linear mixed model fit by REML. t-tests use Satterthwaite's method ['lmerModLmerTest']
## Formula: I(log(corrected_mass)) ~ sang_prop + I(head_width^2) + (1 | colony)
## Data: model_input
##
## REML criterion at convergence: 77.4
##
## Scaled residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -1.94324 -0.51856  0.06638  0.66444  1.47139
##
## Random effects:
## Groups   Name                Variance Std.Dev.
## colony   (Intercept)  0.07045   0.2654
## Residual                    0.21112   0.4595
## Number of obs: 32, groups: colony, 16
##
## Fixed effects:
##              Estimate Std. Error      df t value Pr(>|t|)
```

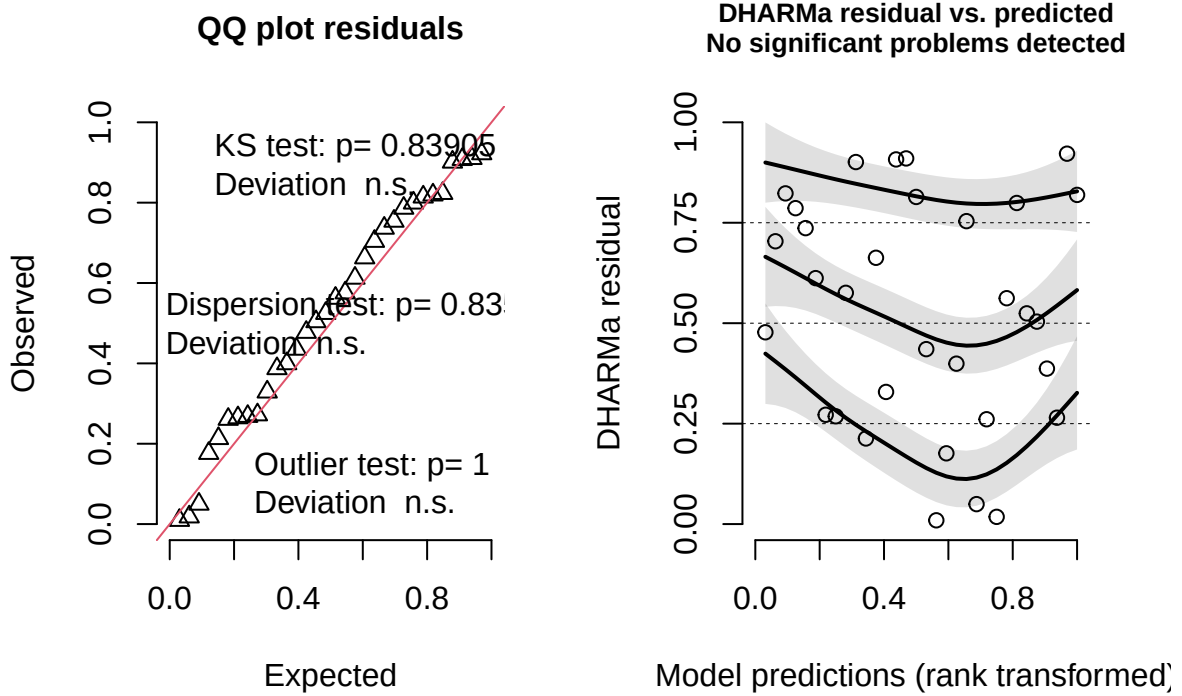
```
## (Intercept)      5.190e-01  5.136e-01  2.893e+01   1.010  0.32071
## sang_prop        1.042e+00  2.968e-01  2.431e+01   3.510  0.00177 **
## I(head_width^2) -4.705e-07  2.899e-07  2.808e+01  -1.623  0.11576
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## Correlation of Fixed Effects:
##          (Intr) sng_pr
## sang_prop  -0.295
## I(hd_wdt^2) -0.945  0.047
## fit warnings:
## Some predictor variables are on very different scales: consider rescaling

##
## Shapiro-Wilk normality test
##
## data:  residuals(lm_model)
## W = 0.95837, p-value = 0.2478
```

Model conditional residuals



DHARMA residual



Similarly to mature *F. sanguinea* ants, in callow workers there is negative but not significant relationship between body size and normalized CHC amount.

4.3 Change of the CHCs associated with *F. sanguinea*

In this section the subset of peaks were used to calculate normalized CHC mass. These were peaks identified as *F. sanguinea* markers.

4.3.1 Mature *F. sanguinea* ants

$$\log(\text{CHC_mass_mature}) = \beta_0 + \text{sanguinea_proportion} + (1|\text{colony_ID}) + (1|\text{colony_ID:sampling_occasion_ID}) + \epsilon,$$

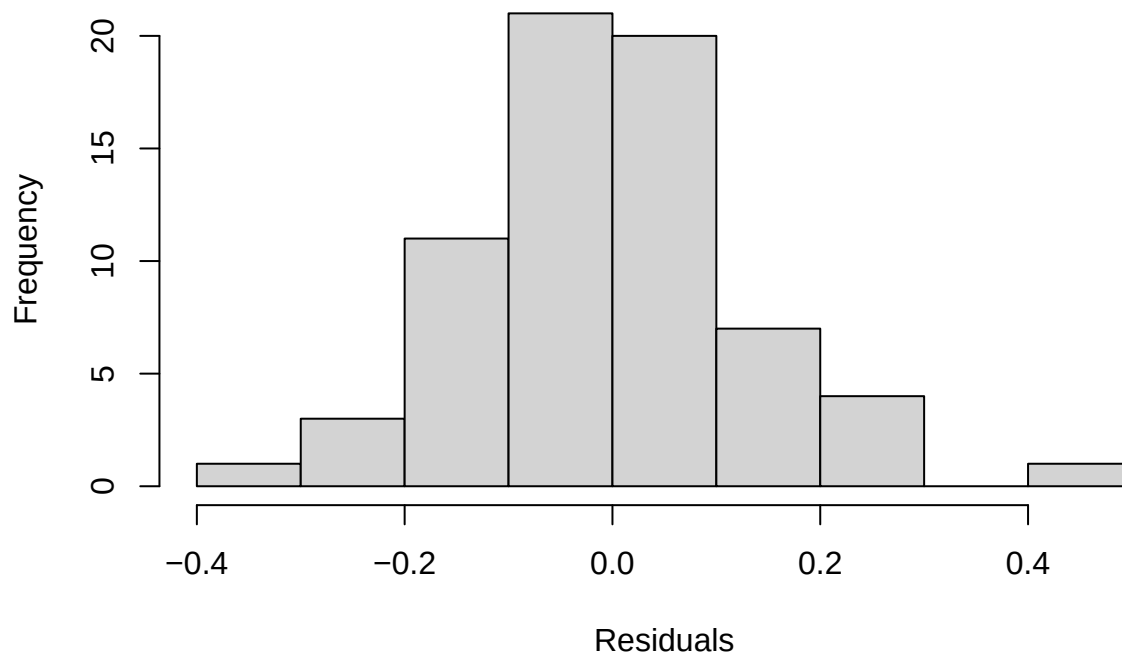
where CHC_mass_mature denotes the normalized mass of *F. sanguinea* markers on the body of adult *F. sanguinea* worker.

```
## Linear mixed model fit by REML. t-tests use Satterthwaite's method ['lmerModLmerTest']
## Formula: I(log(corrected_mass + 1)) ~ sang_prop + (1 | colony:census_date) + (1 | colony)
## Data: model_input
##
## REML criterion at convergence: 18.6
##
## Scaled residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -1.98685 -0.36446 -0.07957  0.39465  2.48253
```

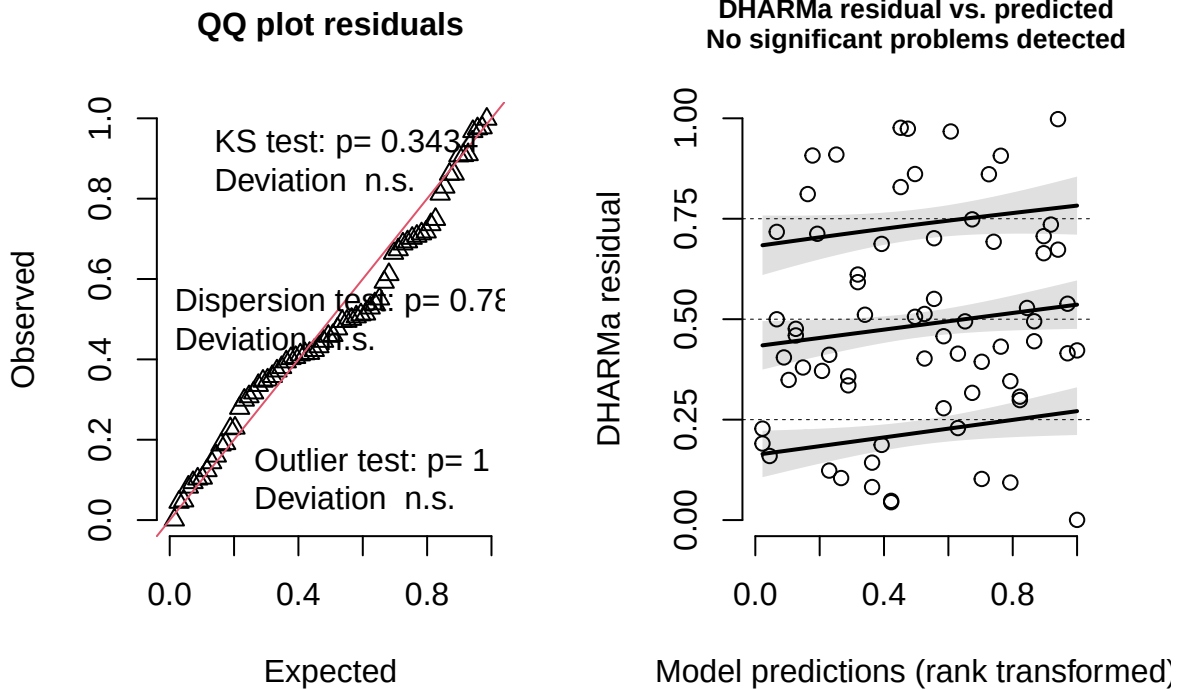
```
##
## Random effects:
##   Groups          Name          Variance Std.Dev.
## colony:census_date (Intercept) 5.306e-02 2.303e-01
## colony              (Intercept) 9.400e-18 3.066e-09
## Residual                        3.235e-02 1.799e-01
## Number of obs: 68, groups: colony:census_date, 44; colony, 16
##
## Fixed effects:
##              Estimate Std. Error      df t value Pr(>|t|)
## (Intercept)  0.22642    0.07296 40.08019   3.103   0.0035 **
## sang_prop    1.16264    0.14177 39.52578   8.201 4.62e-10 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## Correlation of Fixed Effects:
##              (Intr)
## sang_prop -0.823
## optimizer (nloptwrap) convergence code: 0 (OK)
## boundary (singular) fit: see help('isSingular')

##
## Shapiro-Wilk normality test
##
## data: residuals(lm_model)
## W = 0.97834, p-value = 0.2833
```

Model conditional residuals



DHARMA residual



4.3.2 *F. fusca* ants

$$\sqrt{(\text{CHC_mass_fusca})} = \beta_0 + \text{sanguinea_proportion} + \text{head_width}^2 + (1|\text{colony_ID}) + (1|\text{colony_ID}:\text{sampling_occasion_ID}) +$$

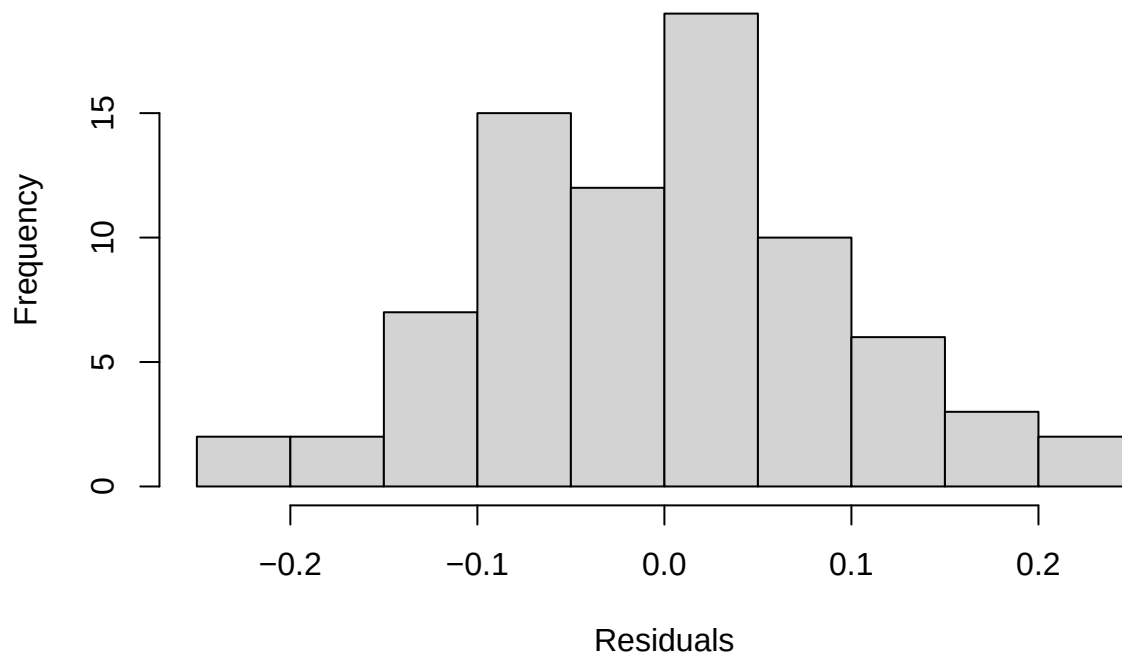
where CHC_mass_fusca denotes the normalized mass of *F. sanguinea* markers on the body of adult *F. sanguinea* worker.

```
## Linear mixed model fit by REML. t-tests use Satterthwaite's method ['lmerModLmerTest']
## Formula: I(sqrt(corrected_mass)) ~ sang_prop + I(head_width^2) + (1 | colony:census_date)
## Data: model_input
##
## REML criterion at convergence: -40.8
##
## Scaled residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -1.83082 -0.49661  0.03171  0.44788  1.87489
##
## Random effects:
## Groups              Name              Variance Std.Dev.
## colony:census_date (Intercept) 0.009894 0.09947
## Residual                  0.013089 0.11441
## Number of obs: 78, groups: colony:census_date, 55
##
## Fixed effects:
##              Estimate Std. Error      df t value Pr(>|t|)
```

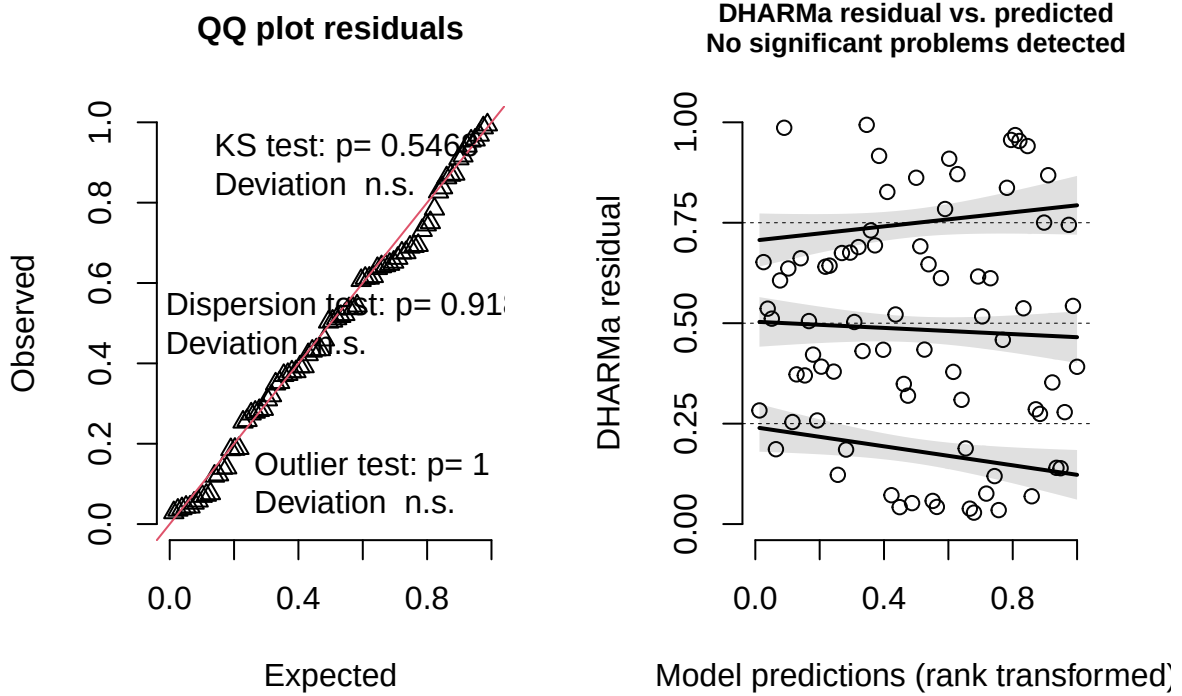
```
## (Intercept)      5.795e-01  1.187e-01  6.889e+01   4.884 6.49e-06 ***
## sang_prop        5.493e-01  6.715e-02  5.172e+01   8.180 6.87e-11 ***
## I(head_width^2) -1.603e-07  1.006e-07  6.993e+01  -1.594   0.116
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## Correlation of Fixed Effects:
##      (Intr) sng_pr
## sang_prop    0.052
## I(hd_wdt^2) -0.972 -0.224
## fit warnings:
## Some predictor variables are on very different scales: consider rescaling

##
## Shapiro-Wilk normality test
##
## data:  residuals(lm_model)
## W = 0.98669, p-value = 0.596
```

Model conditional residuals



DHARMA residual



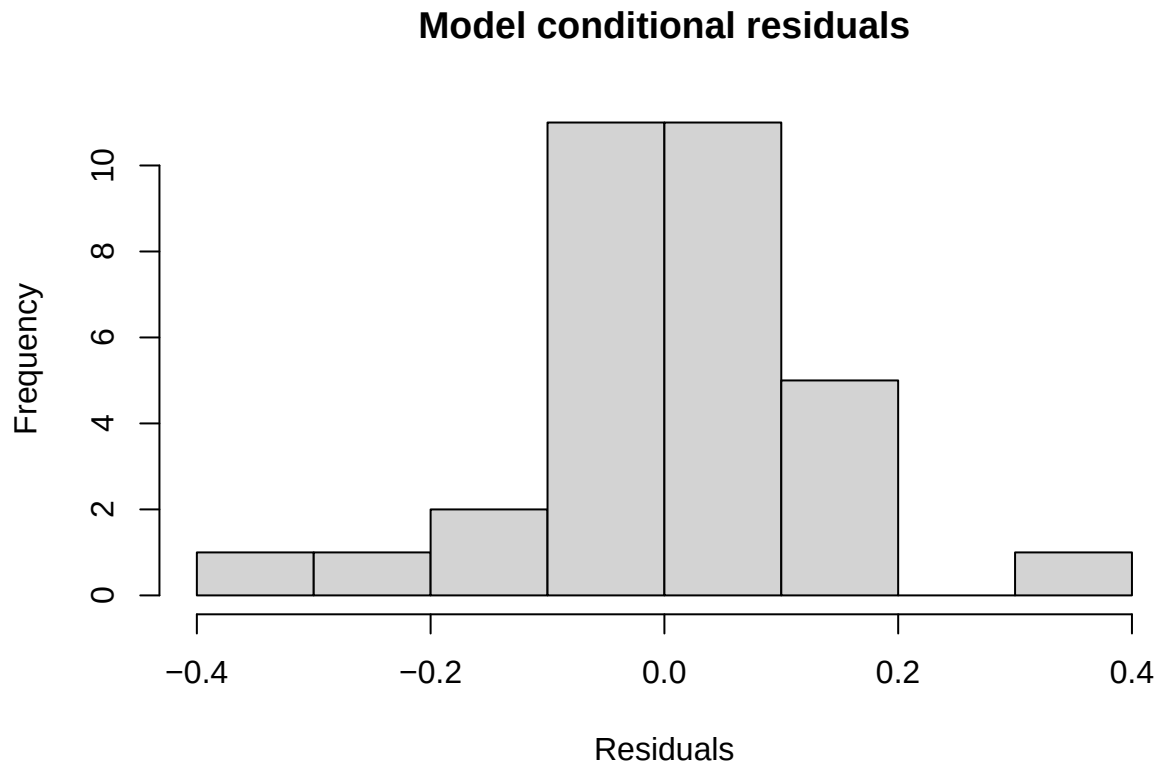
4.3.3 Callow *F. sanguinea* ants

$$\sqrt[3]{(\text{CHC_mass_mature})} = \beta_0 + \text{sanguinea_proportion} + \epsilon,$$

where CHC_mass_mature denotes the normalized mass of *F. sanguinea* markers on the body of callow *F. sanguinea* worker.

```
##
## Call:
## lm(formula = I((corrected_mass)^(1/3)) ~ sang_prop, data = model_input)
##
## Residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -0.37888 -0.07244  0.02268  0.08319  0.30937
##
## Coefficients:
##              Estimate Std. Error t value Pr(>|t|)
## (Intercept)  0.29848    0.04202   7.104  6.7e-08 ***
## sang_prop    0.63173    0.07899   7.998  6.3e-09 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## Residual standard error: 0.1335 on 30 degrees of freedom
## Multiple R-squared:  0.6807, Adjusted R-squared:  0.6701
## F-statistic: 63.96 on 1 and 30 DF, p-value: 6.305e-09
```

```
##
## Shapiro-Wilk normality test
##
## data: residuals(lm_model)
## W = 0.96975, p-value = 0.4925
```



4.4 Change of the CHCs associated with *F. fusca*

Similarly to the analysis with the use of markers of *F. sanguinea* workers, the procedure was repeated using the mass of *F. fusca* markers as a response variable.

4.4.1 Mature *F. sanguinea* ants

$\log(\text{CHC_mass_mature}) = \beta_0 + \text{sanguinea_proportion} + (1|\text{colony_ID}) + (1|\text{colony_ID}:\text{sampling_occasion_ID}) + \epsilon$,
 where CHC_mass_mature denotes the normalized mass of *F. fusca* markers on the body of adult *F. sanguinea* worker.

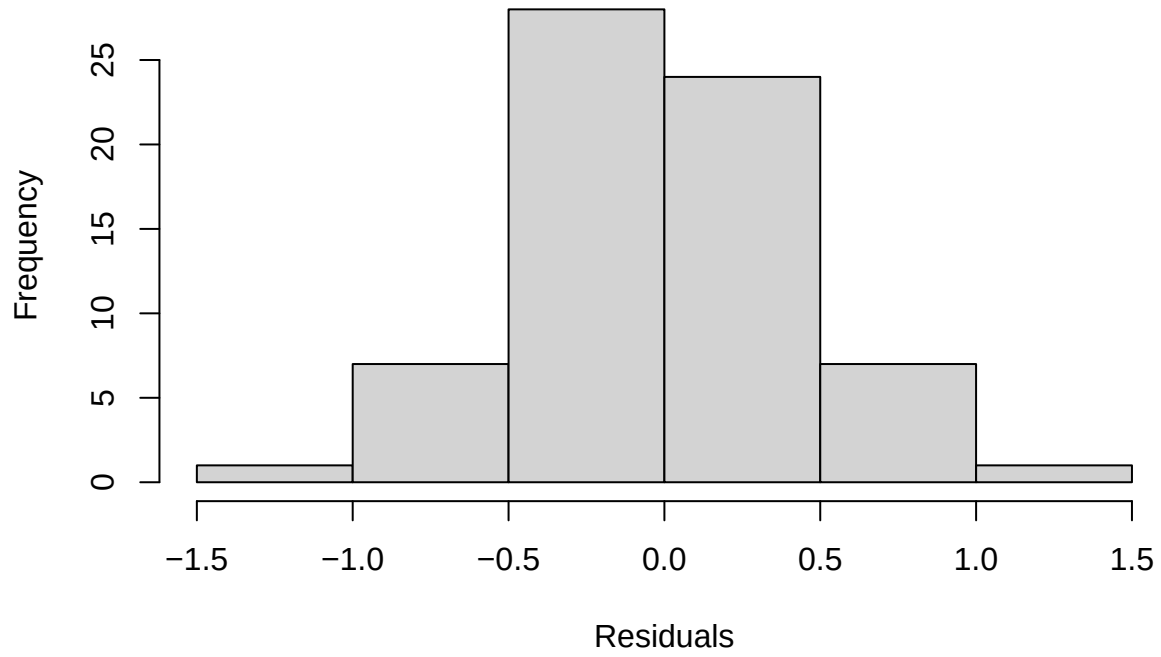
```
## Linear mixed model fit by REML. t-tests use Satterthwaite's method ['lmerModLmerTest']
## Formula: I(log(corrected_mass)) ~ sang_prop + (1 | colony:census_date) + (1 | colony)
## Data: model_input
##
## REML criterion at convergence: 154.6
##
```

```

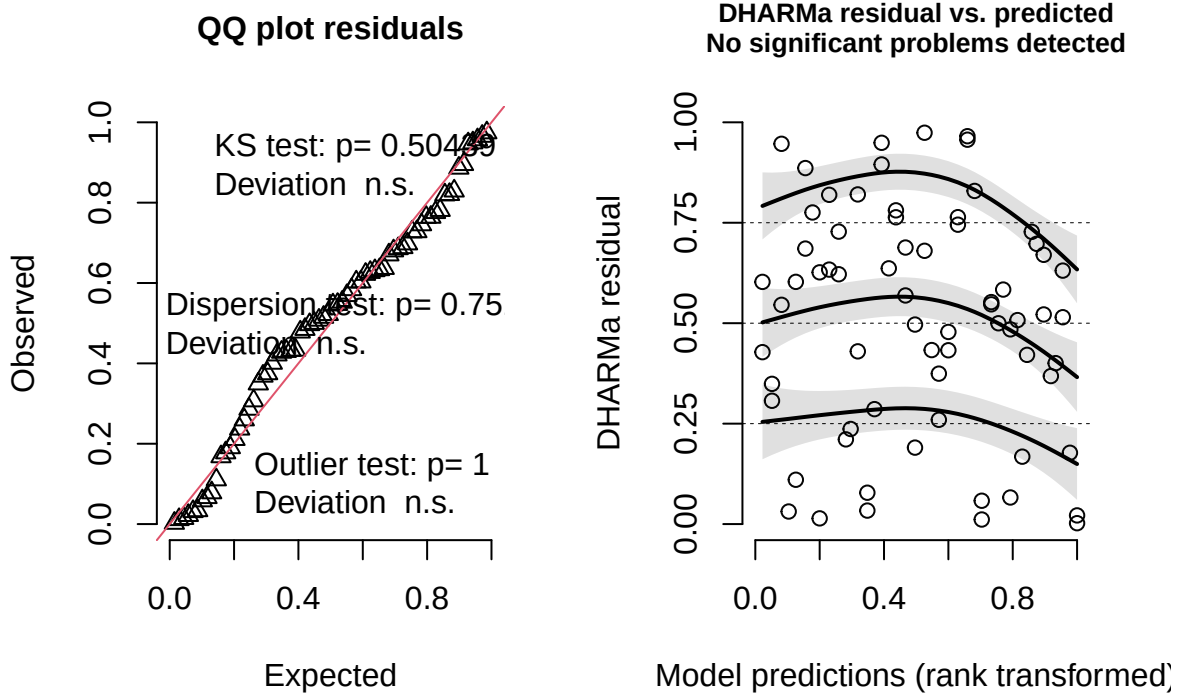
## Scaled residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -2.32675 -0.47439 -0.04918  0.42137  2.01162
##
## Random effects:
##   Groups             Name             Variance Std.Dev.
## colony:census_date (Intercept) 0.1184    0.3442
## colony              (Intercept) 0.3702    0.6084
## Residual                        0.3039    0.5513
## Number of obs: 68, groups: colony:census_date, 44; colony, 16
##
## Fixed effects:
##              Estimate Std. Error      df t value Pr(>|t|)
## (Intercept)  -0.5686     0.2268 31.9619  -2.507   0.0174 *
## sang_prop    -1.8817     0.3262 30.8622  -5.769 2.41e-06 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## Correlation of Fixed Effects:
##              (Intr)
## sang_prop -0.626
##
##
## Shapiro-Wilk normality test
##
## data: residuals(lm_model)
## W = 0.98815, p-value = 0.7693

```

Model conditional residuals



DHARMA residual



4.4.2 *F. fusca* ants

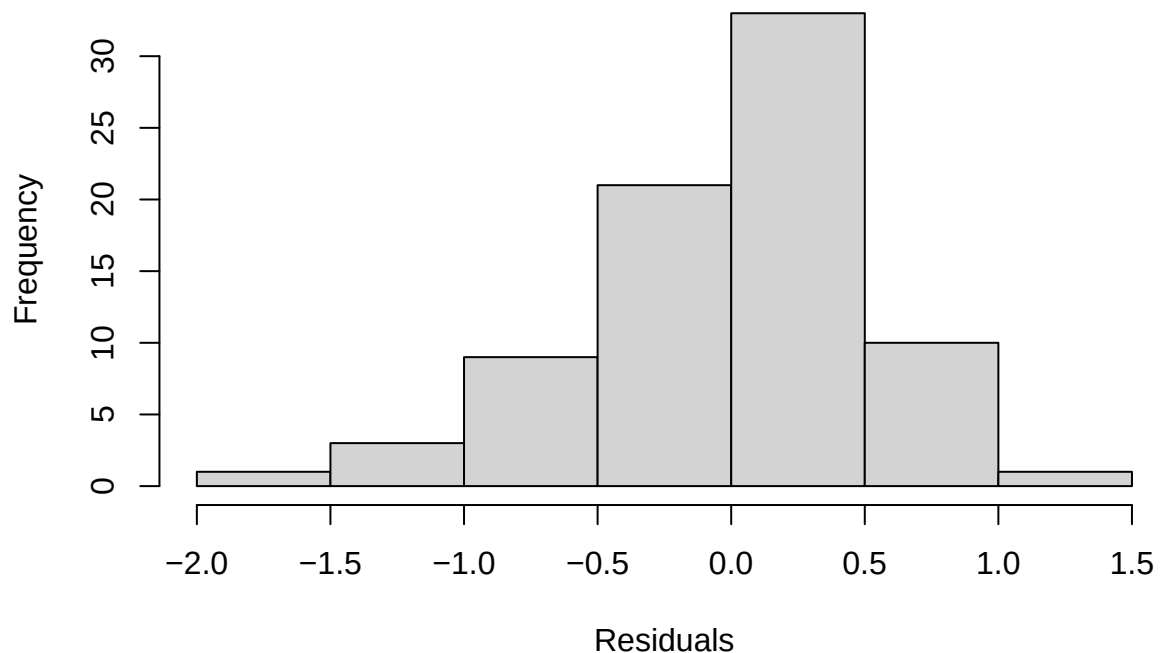
$\log(\text{CHC_mass_mature} + 0.01) = \beta_0 + \text{sanguinea_proportion} + \text{head_width}^2 + (1|\text{colony_ID}) + (1|\text{colony_ID}:\text{sampling_occasion})$
 where CHC_mass_mature denotes the normalized mass of *F. fusca* markers on the body of *F. fusca* worker.

```
## Linear mixed model fit by REML. t-tests use Satterthwaite's method ['lmerModLmerTest']
## Formula: I(log(corrected_mass + 0.01)) ~ sang_prop + I(head_width^2) +
## (1 | colony) + (1 | colony:census_date)
## Data: model_input
##
## REML criterion at convergence: 198.3
##
## Scaled residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -2.56390 -0.62519  0.05594  0.58570  2.25157
##
## Random effects:
## Groups              Name            Variance Std.Dev.
## colony:census_date (Intercept) 6.104e-10 2.471e-05
## colony              (Intercept) 2.590e-01 5.089e-01
## Residual                        3.830e-01 6.188e-01
## Number of obs: 78, groups: colony:census_date, 55; colony, 20
##
## Fixed effects:
```

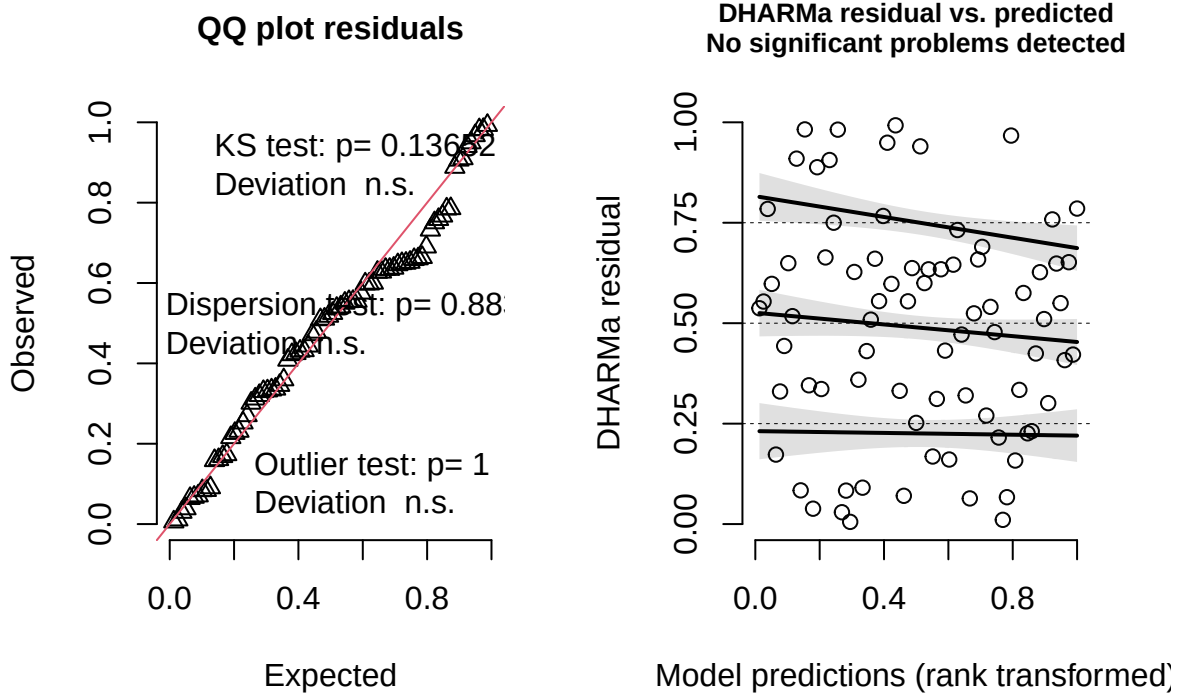
```
##               Estimate Std. Error      df t value Pr(>|t|)
## (Intercept)    1.913e-03  6.383e-01  7.162e+01   0.003   0.9976
## sang_prop      -1.367e+00  2.715e-01  6.631e+01  -5.034  3.93e-06 ***
## I(head_width^2) -9.525e-07  5.398e-07  7.330e+01  -1.765   0.0818 .
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## Correlation of Fixed Effects:
##           (Intr) sng_pr
## sang_prop    0.088
## I(hd_wdt^2) -0.969 -0.212
## fit warnings:
## Some predictor variables are on very different scales: consider rescaling
## optimizer (nloptwrap) convergence code: 0 (OK)
## boundary (singular) fit: see help('isSingular')

##
## Shapiro-Wilk normality test
##
## data:  residuals(lm_model)
## W = 0.98552, p-value = 0.5236
```

Model conditional residuals



DHARMa residual



4.4.3 Callow *F. sanguinea* ants

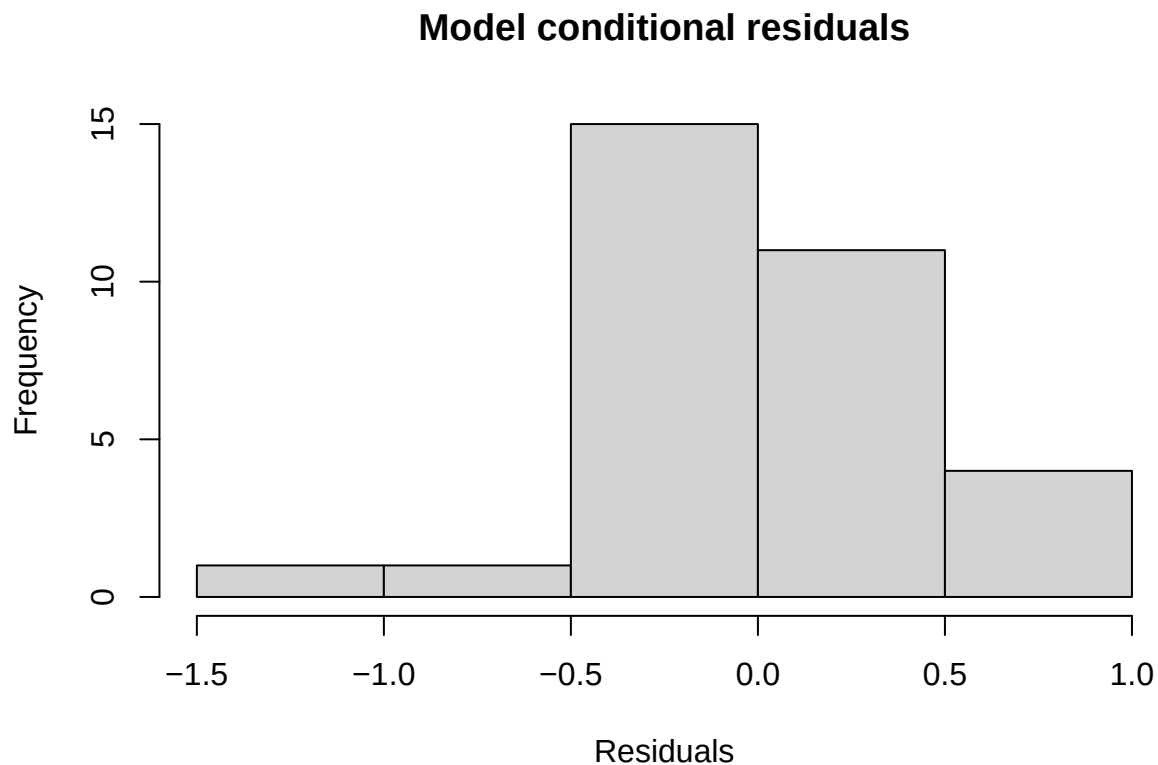
$$\log(\text{CHC_mass_mature}) = \beta_0 + \text{sanguinea_proportion} + (1|\text{colony_ID}) + \epsilon,$$

where $\log(\text{CHC_mass_mature})$ denotes the normalized mass of *F. fusca* markers on the body of callow *F. sanguinea* worker.

```
## Linear mixed model fit by REML. t-tests use Satterthwaite's method ['lmerModLmerTest']
## Formula: I(log(corrected_mass)) ~ sang_prop + (1 | colony)
## Data: model_input
##
## REML criterion at convergence: 64.7
##
## Scaled residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -2.29425 -0.57286 -0.03774  0.61675  1.83684
##
## Random effects:
## Groups   Name                Variance Std.Dev.
## colony   (Intercept)  0.2338     0.4835
## Residual                    0.2733     0.5228
## Number of obs: 32, groups: colony, 16
##
## Fixed effects:
##              Estimate Std. Error    df t value Pr(>|t|)
```

```
## (Intercept)  -1.9565      0.2187 28.3341  -8.944 9.58e-10 ***
## sang_prop    -0.1866      0.3551 20.4211  -0.525  0.605
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## Correlation of Fixed Effects:
##          (Intr)
## sang_prop -0.700

##
## Shapiro-Wilk normality test
##
## data:  residuals(lm_model)
## W = 0.97969, p-value = 0.7905
```

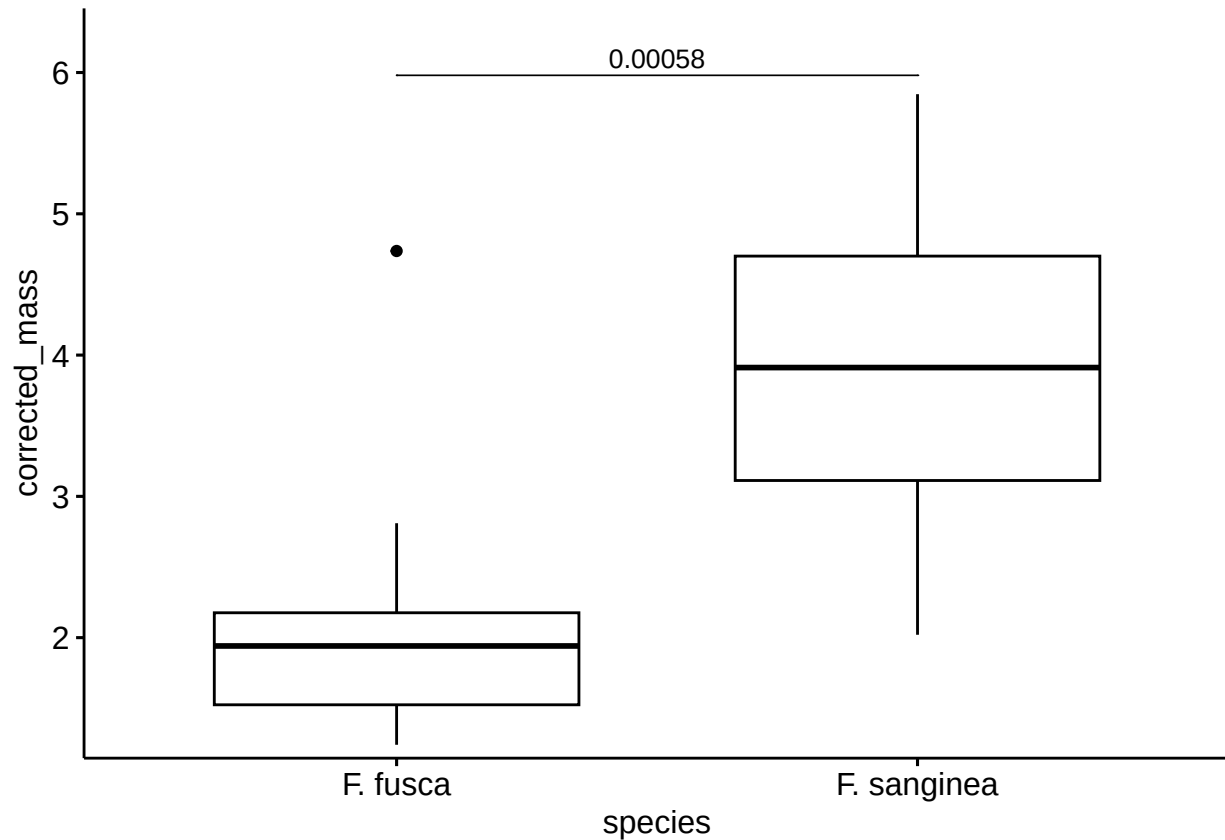


5 Comparison of the amount and proportions of CHC between species and age categories

This section presents the results of Wilcoxon tests comparing features of CHC profiles between callow and mature *F. sanguinea* ants as well as *F. fusca* slaves. Samples from the same colony were averaged before calculation of the final statistics to account for their non-independence.

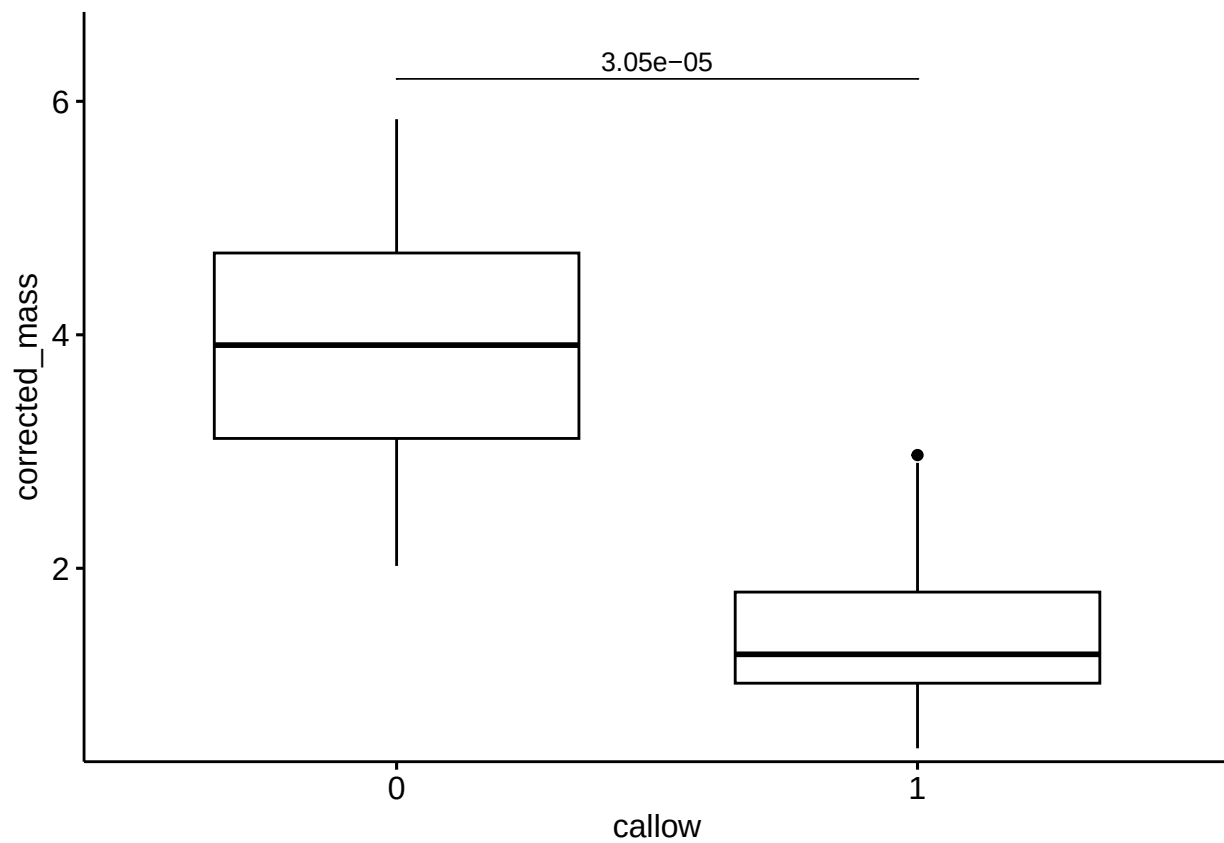
5.1 Difference in the total CHC amount between *F. sanguinea* and *F. fusca*

```
## # A tibble: 1 x 7
##   .y.      group1 group2      n1      n2 statistic      p
## * <chr>    <chr>  <chr>    <int> <int>    <dbl>   <dbl>
## 1 corrected_mass F. fusca F. sanguinea    16    16         7 0.00058
```

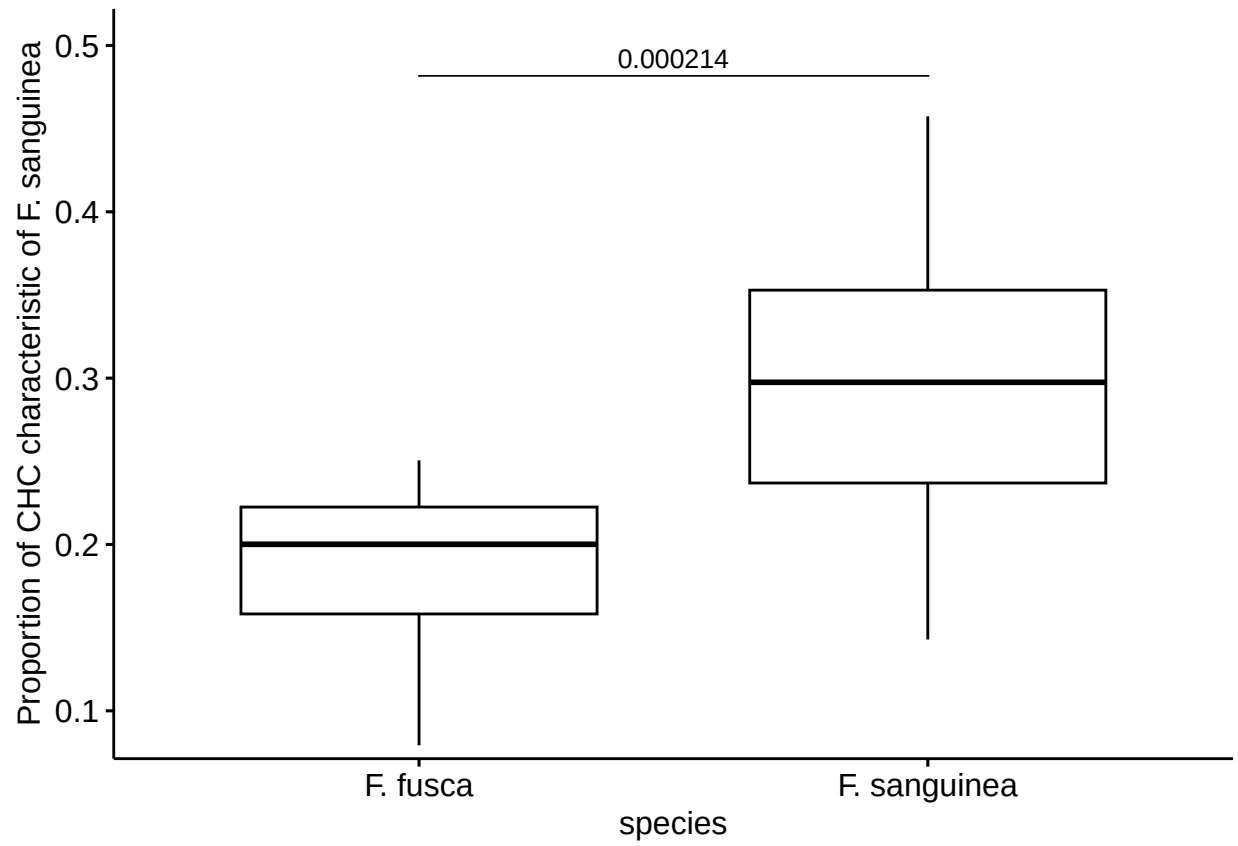


5.2 Difference in the total CHC amount between callow and mature *F. sanguinea*

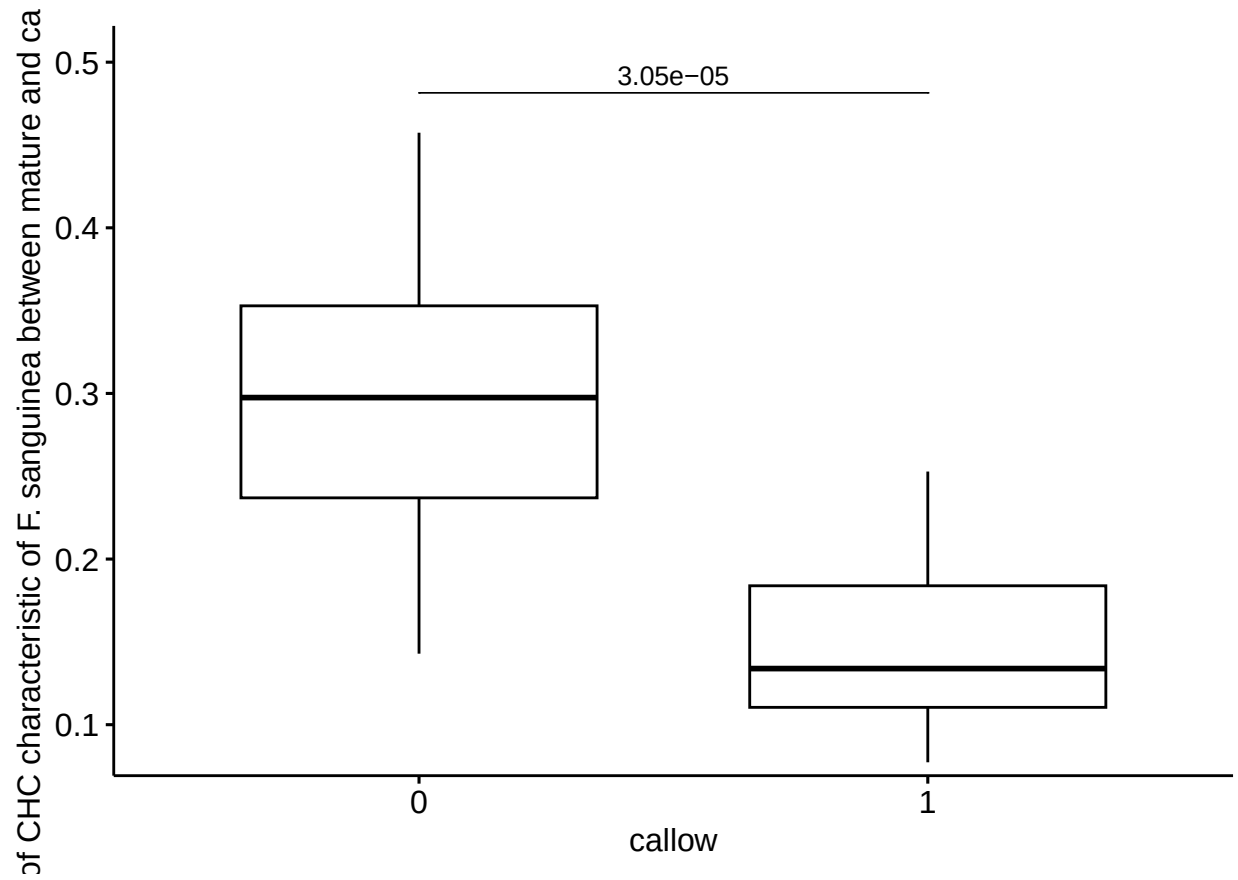
```
## # A tibble: 1 x 7
##   .y.      group1 group2      n1      n2 statistic      p
## * <chr>    <chr>  <chr>    <int> <int>    <dbl>   <dbl>
## 1 corrected_mass 0      1      16    16     136 0.0000305
```



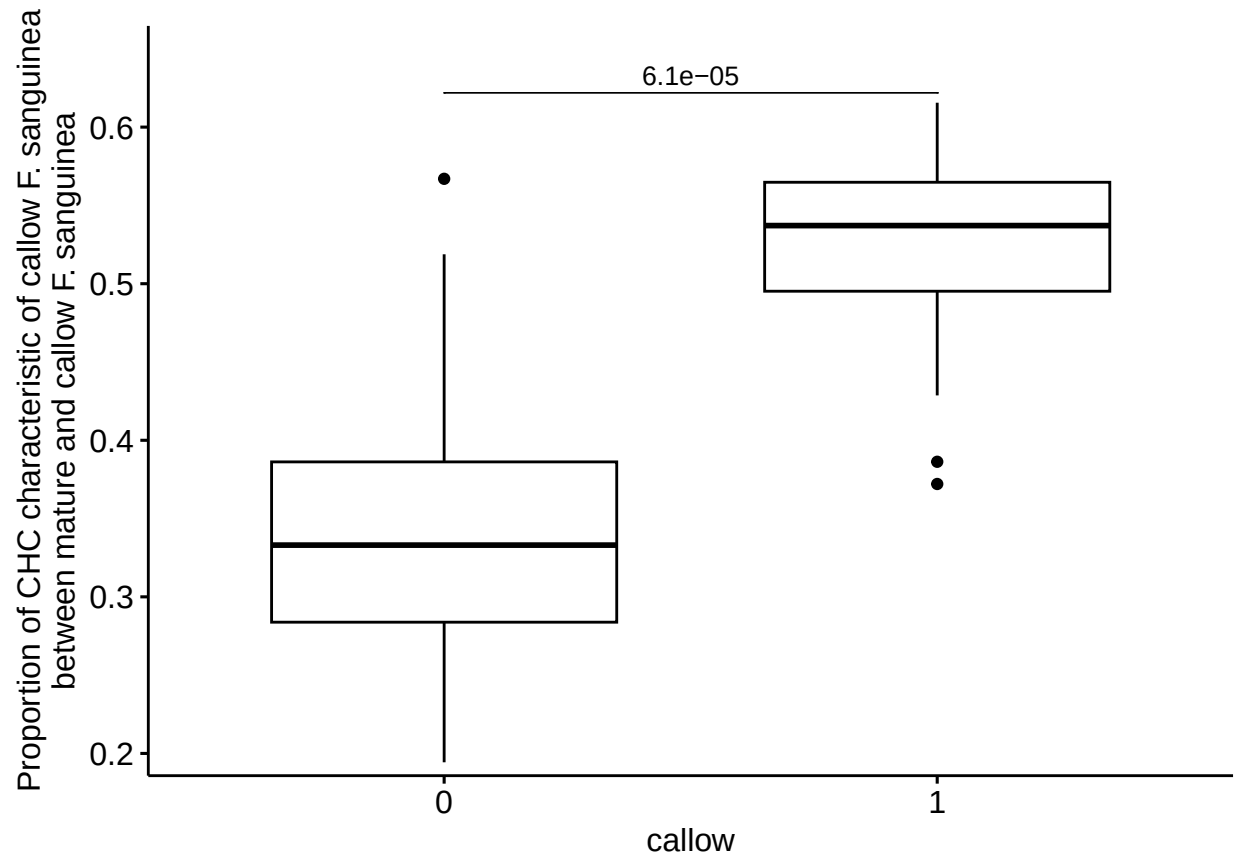
5.3 Difference in the proportion of CHC characteristic of *F. sanguinea* between mature *F. sanguinea* and *F. fusca*



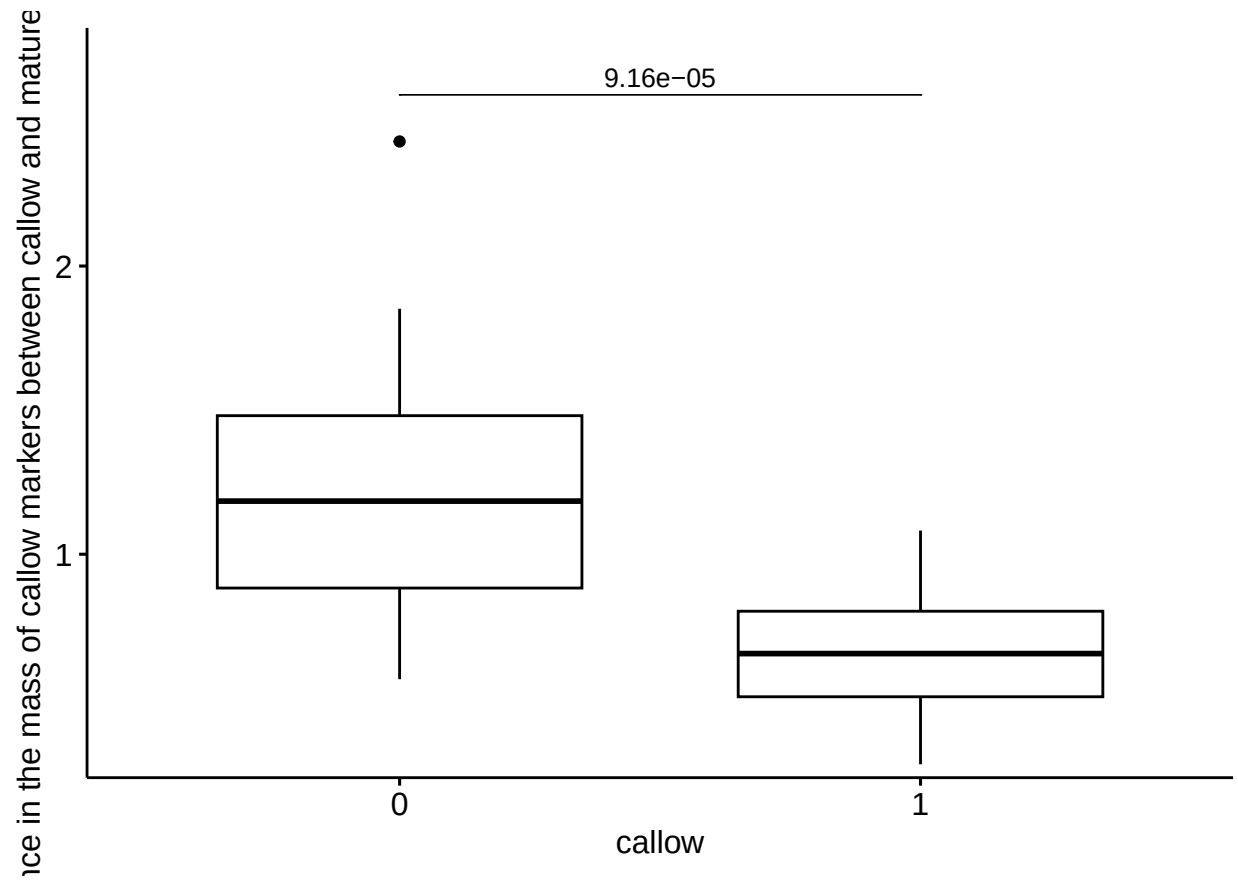
5.4 Difference in the proportion of CHC characteristic of *F. sanguinea* between mature and callow *F. sanguinea*



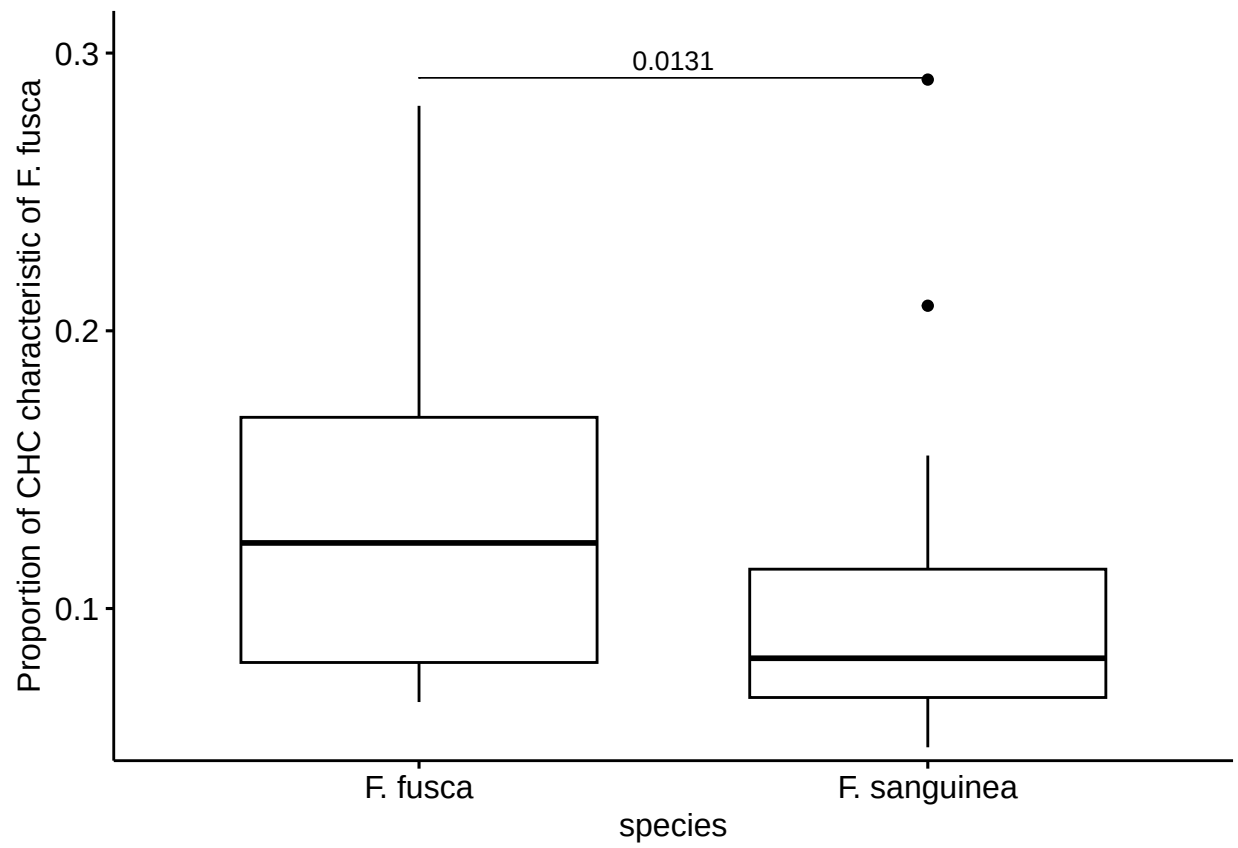
5.5 Difference in the proportion of CHC characteristic of callow *F. sanguinea* between mature and callow *F. sanguinea*



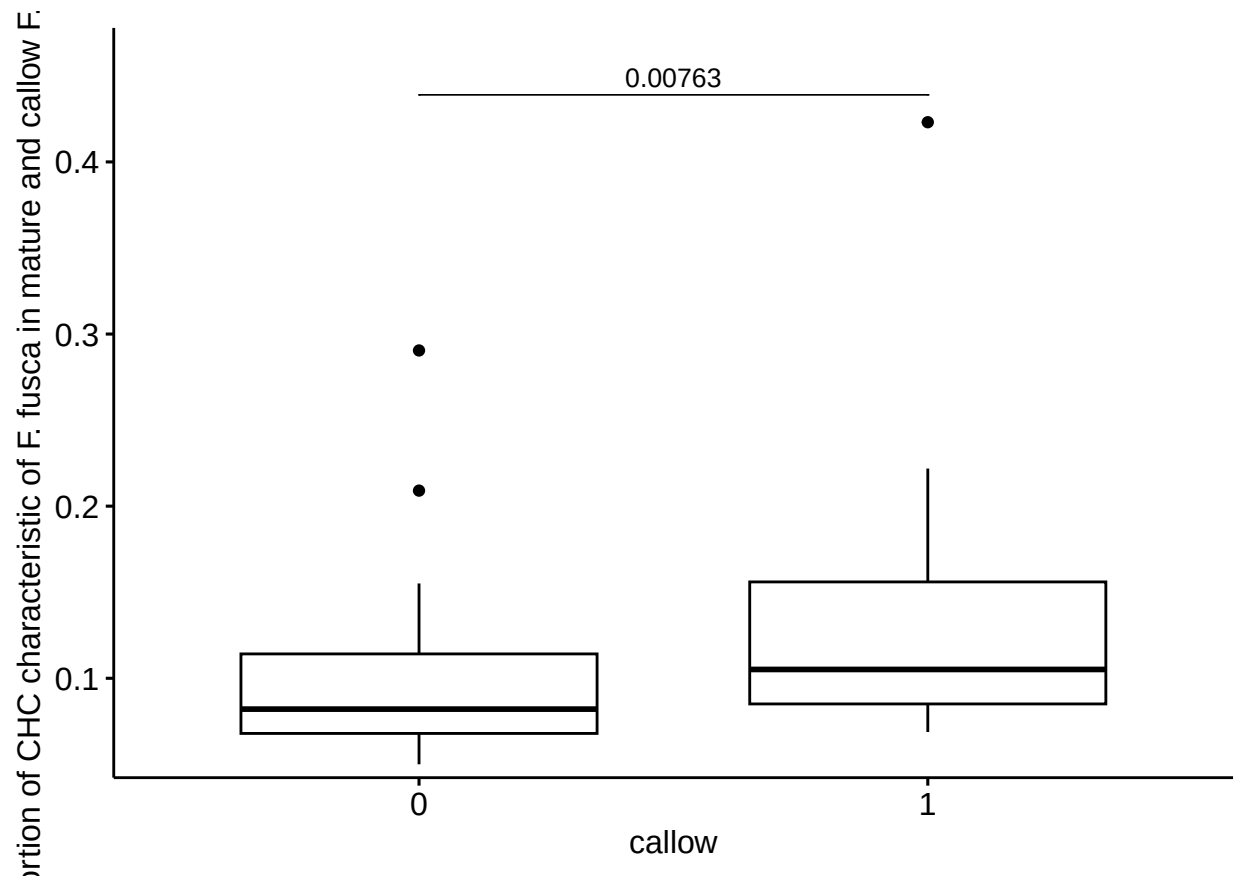
5.6 Difference in the amount of CHC characteristic of callow *F. sanguinea* between mature and callow *F. sanguinea*



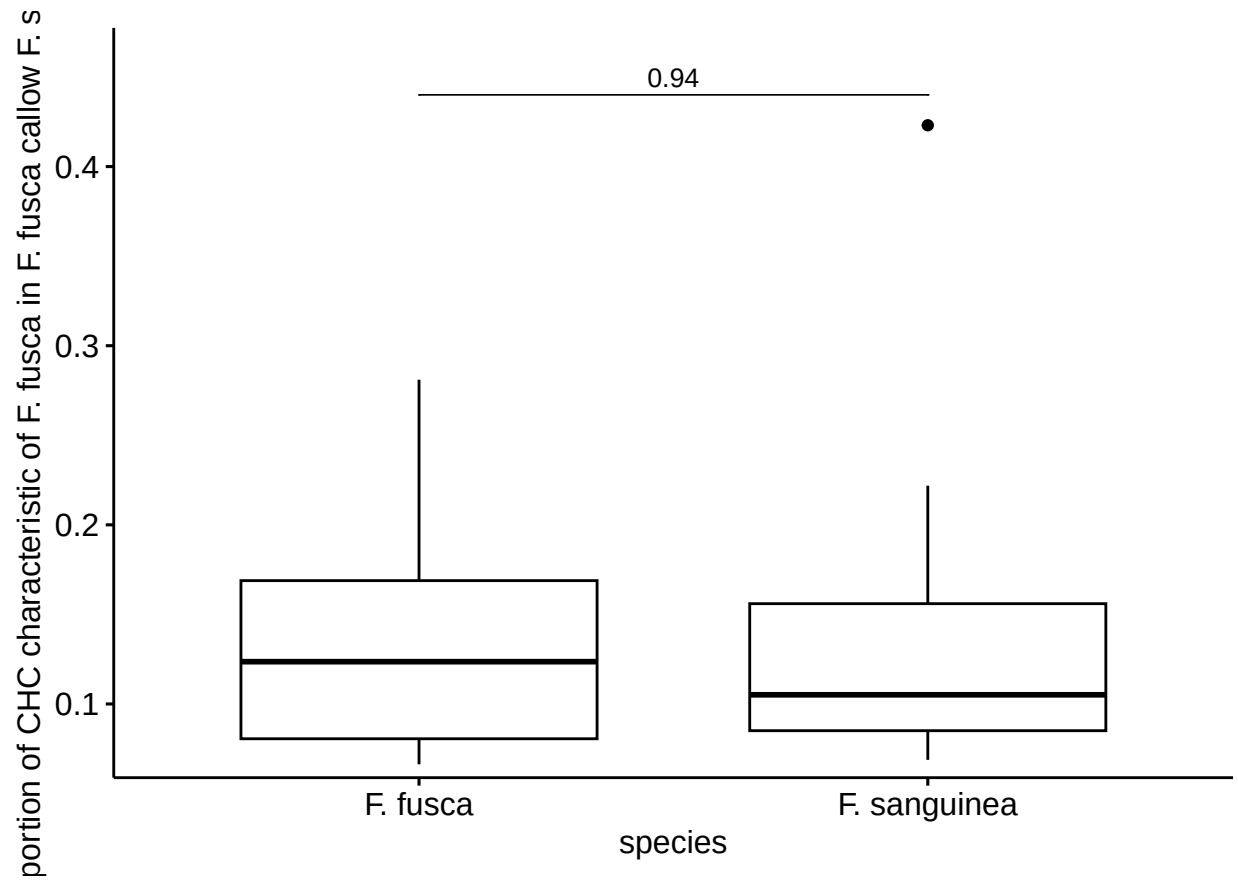
5.7 Difference in the proportion of CHC characteristic of *F. fusca* between mature *F. sanguinea* and *F. fusca*



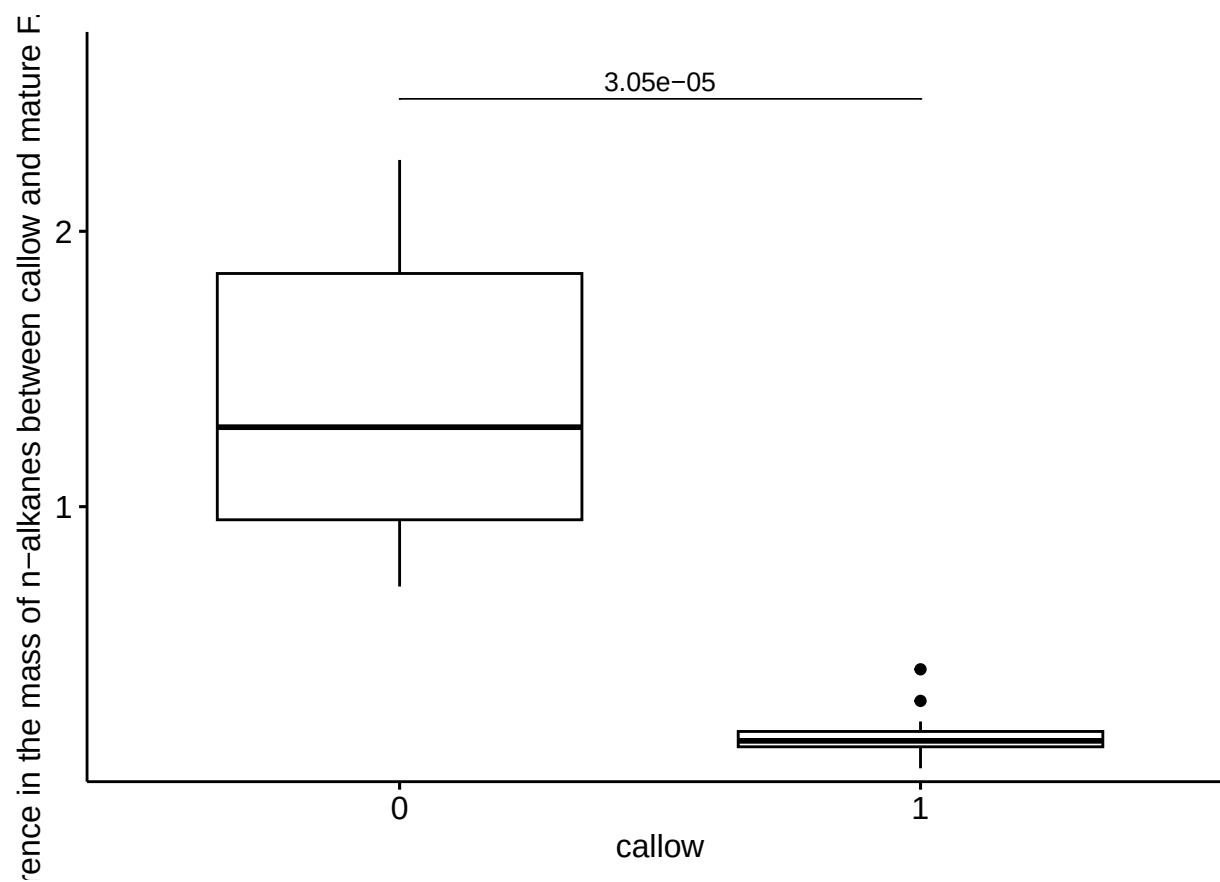
5.8 Difference in the proportion of CHC characteristic of *F. fusca* between mature and callow *F. sanguinea*



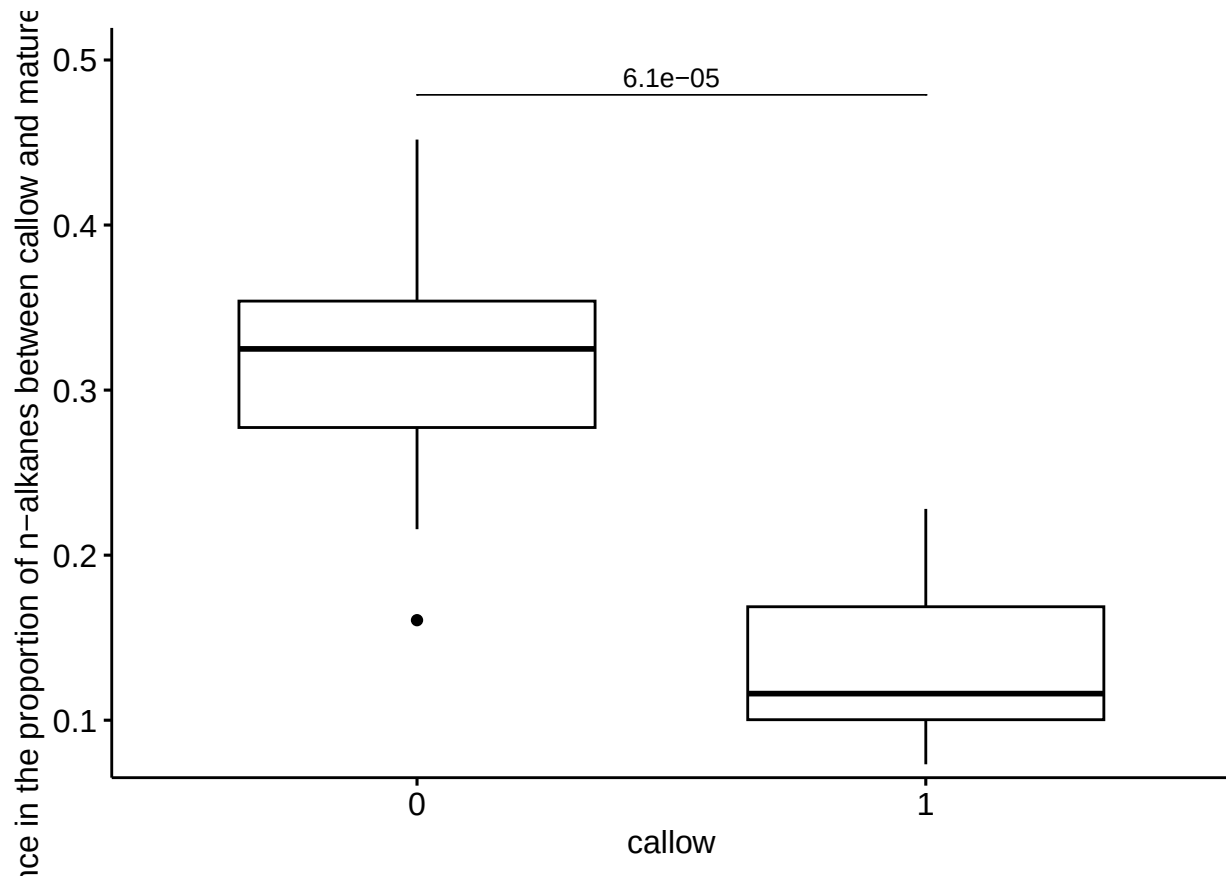
5.9 Difference in the proportion of CHC characteristic of *F. fusca* between
callow *F. sanguinea* and *F. fusca*



5.10 Difference in the mass of *n*-alkanes between callow and mature *F. sanguinea*



5.11 Difference in the proportion of *n*-alkanes between callow and mature *F. sanguinea*



6 Change in the CHC profile in separated callow *F. sanguinea* ants

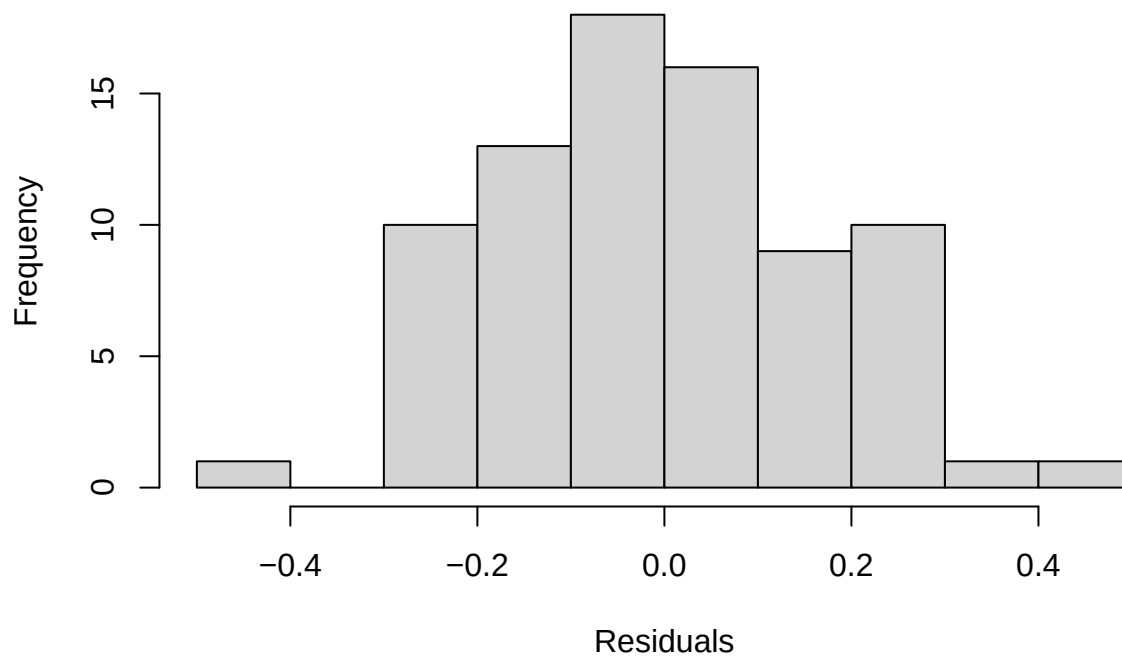
6.1 Change in the total CHC amount over time

```
## Linear mixed model fit by REML. t-tests use Satterthwaite's method ['lmerModLmerTest']
## Formula: I(sqrt(corrected_mass)) ~ mean_delta + (1 | colony)
## Data: separation_data[-74, ]
##
## REML criterion at convergence: -12.9
##
## Scaled residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -2.54596 -0.65494 -0.04106  0.63627  2.54062
##
## Random effects:
## Groups   Name            Variance Std.Dev.
## colony   (Intercept)  0.01293  0.1137
## Residual                    0.03516  0.1875
## Number of obs: 79, groups: colony, 11
```

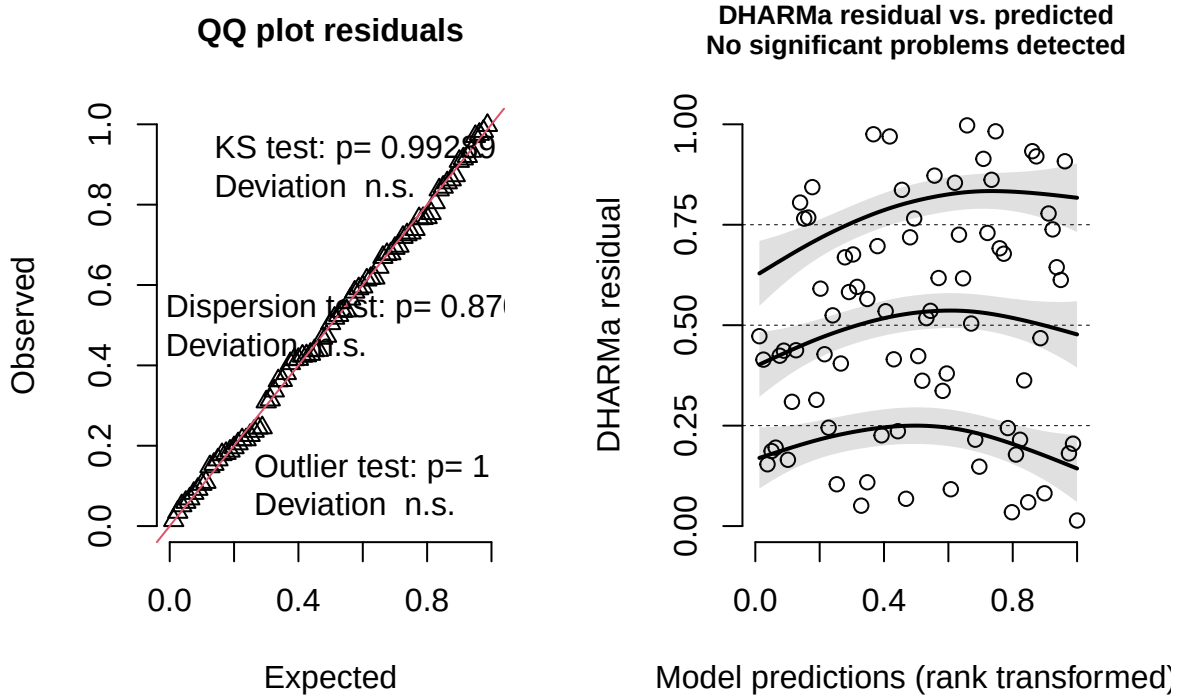
```
##
## Fixed effects:
##           Estimate Std. Error      df t value Pr(>|t|)
## (Intercept)  1.180332   0.047605  16.450772  24.794 1.83e-14 ***
## mean_delta   0.002458   0.001669  68.538937   1.473   0.145
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## Correlation of Fixed Effects:
##           (Intr)
## mean_delta -0.518

##
## Shapiro-Wilk normality test
##
## data:  residuals(lm_model)
## W = 0.99204, p-value = 0.9107
```

Model conditional residuals



DHARMA residual

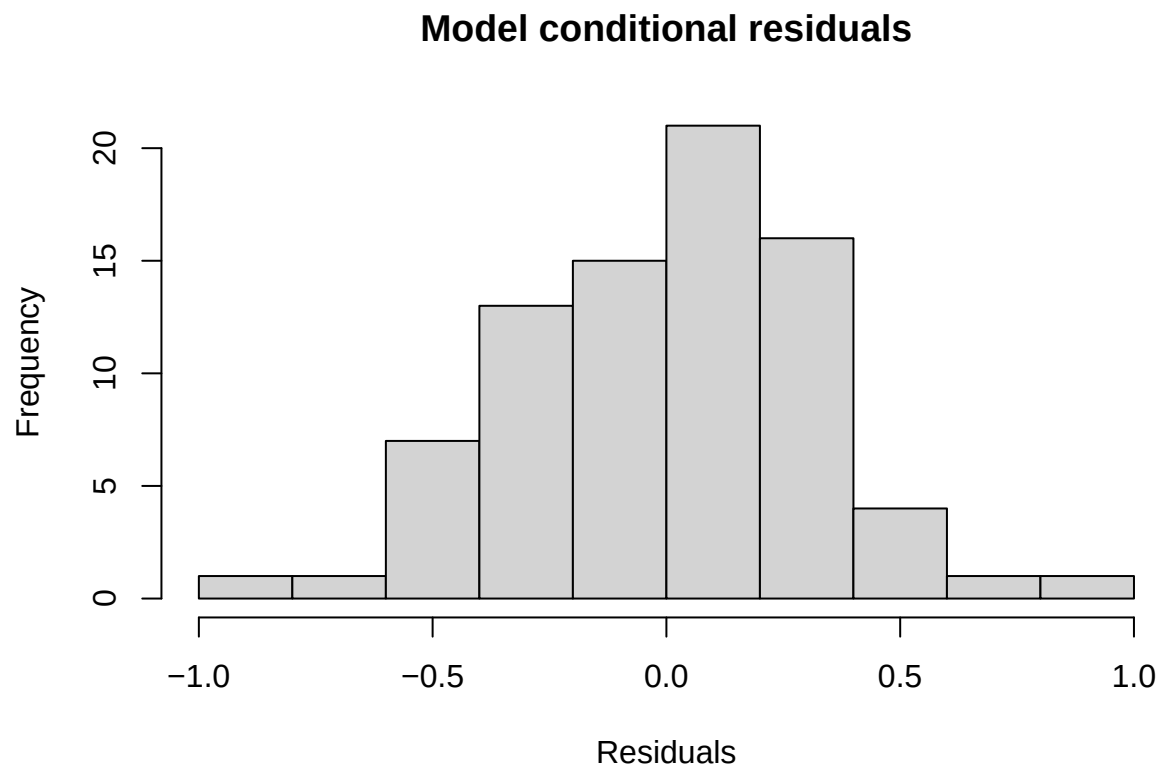


6.2 Change in the amount of compounds associated with callow *F. sanguinea*

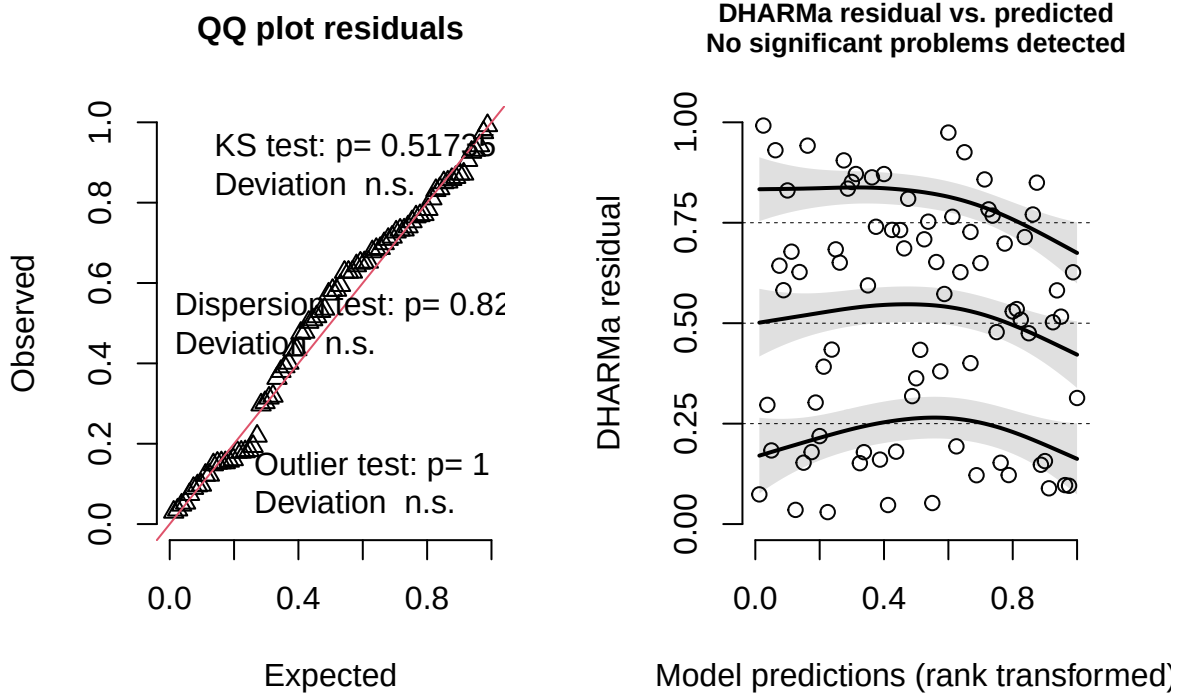
```
## Linear mixed model fit by REML. t-tests use Satterthwaite's method ['lmerModLmerTest']
## Formula: log(corrected_mass_part) ~ mean_delta + (1 | colony)
## Data: separation_data
##
## REML criterion at convergence: 90.5
##
## Scaled residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -2.3283 -0.7175  0.1030  0.6844  2.5692
##
## Random effects:
## Groups Name Variance Std.Dev.
## colony (Intercept) 0.09983 0.3160
## Residual 0.12268 0.3503
## Number of obs: 80, groups: colony, 11
##
## Fixed effects:
## Estimate Std. Error df t value Pr(>|t|)
## (Intercept) -0.348801 0.113427 13.345289 -3.075 0.00863 **
## mean_delta -0.004344 0.003040 68.378442 -1.429 0.15750
## ---
## Signif. codes: 0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
```

```
## Correlation of Fixed Effects:  
##      (Intr)  
## mean_delta -0.405
```

```
##  
## Shapiro-Wilk normality test  
##  
## data:  residuals(lm_model)  
## W = 0.99175, p-value = 0.8938
```



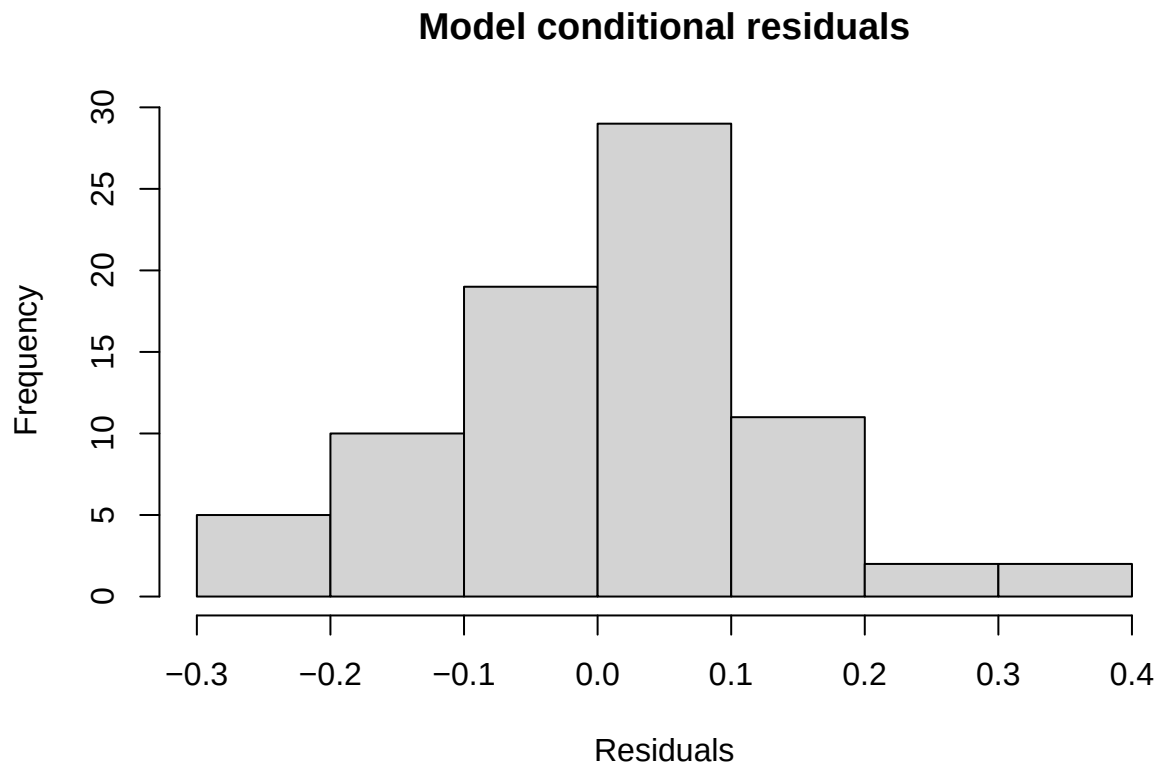
DHARMA residual



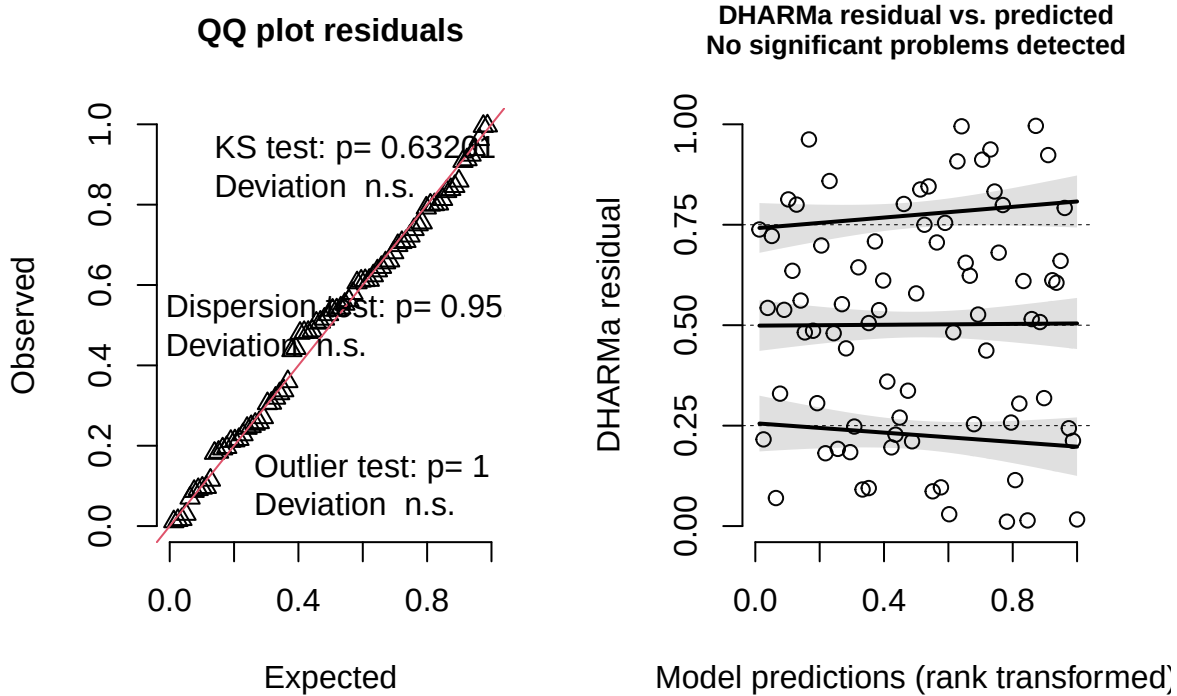
6.3 Change in the amount of compounds associated with *F. sanguinea*

```
## Linear mixed model fit by REML. t-tests use Satterthwaite's method ['lmerModLmerTest']
## Formula: I(sqrt(corrected_mass_part)) ~ poly(mean_delta, 1) + (1 | colony)
## Data: separation_data[-c(69, 74), ]
##
## REML criterion at convergence: -87
##
## Scaled residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -2.19985 -0.64322  0.04887  0.72139  2.56609
##
## Random effects:
## Groups Name Variance Std.Dev.
## colony (Intercept) 0.001593 0.03991
## Residual 0.016477 0.12836
## Number of obs: 78, groups: colony, 11
##
## Fixed effects:
##              Estimate Std. Error      df t value Pr(>|t|)
## (Intercept)    0.53275    0.01916  7.82144   27.81 4.21e-09 ***
## poly(mean_delta, 1) 0.93643    0.12987 69.56931    7.21 5.31e-10 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
```

```
## Correlation of Fixed Effects:  
##      (Intr)  
## ply(mn_d,1) 0.019  
  
##  
## Shapiro-Wilk normality test  
##  
## data:  residuals(lm_model)  
## W = 0.98446, p-value = 0.4618
```



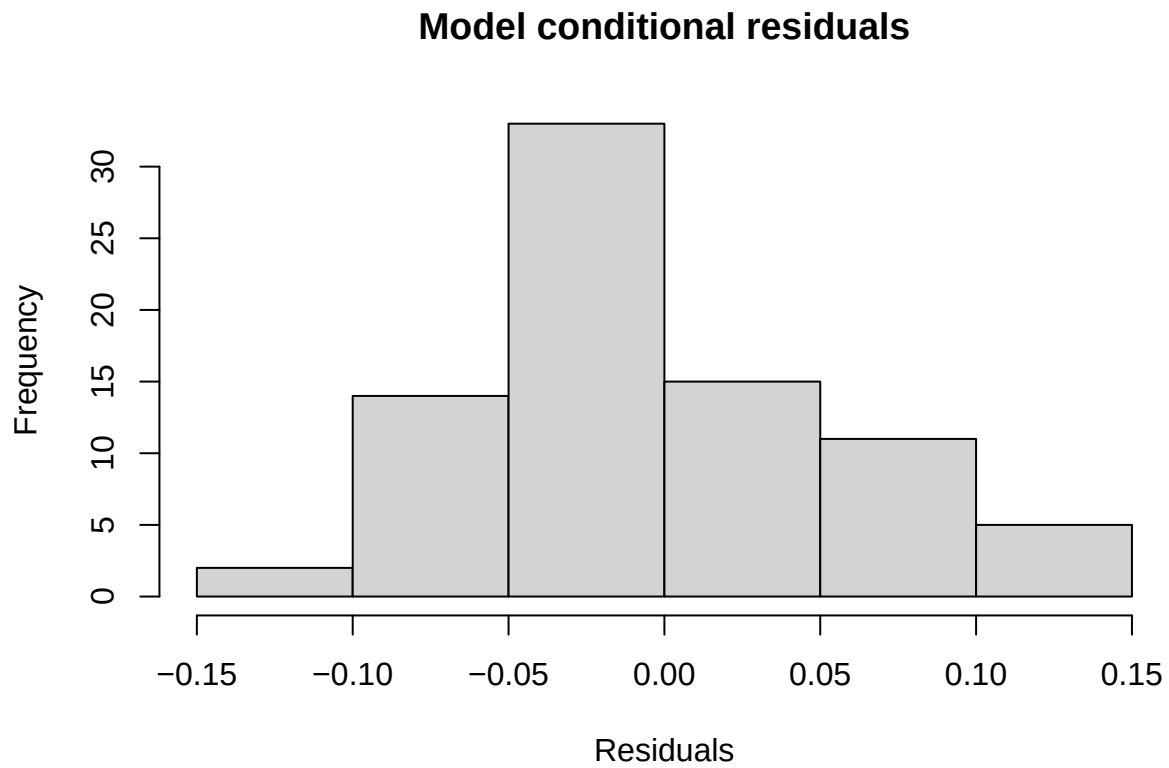
DHARMa residual



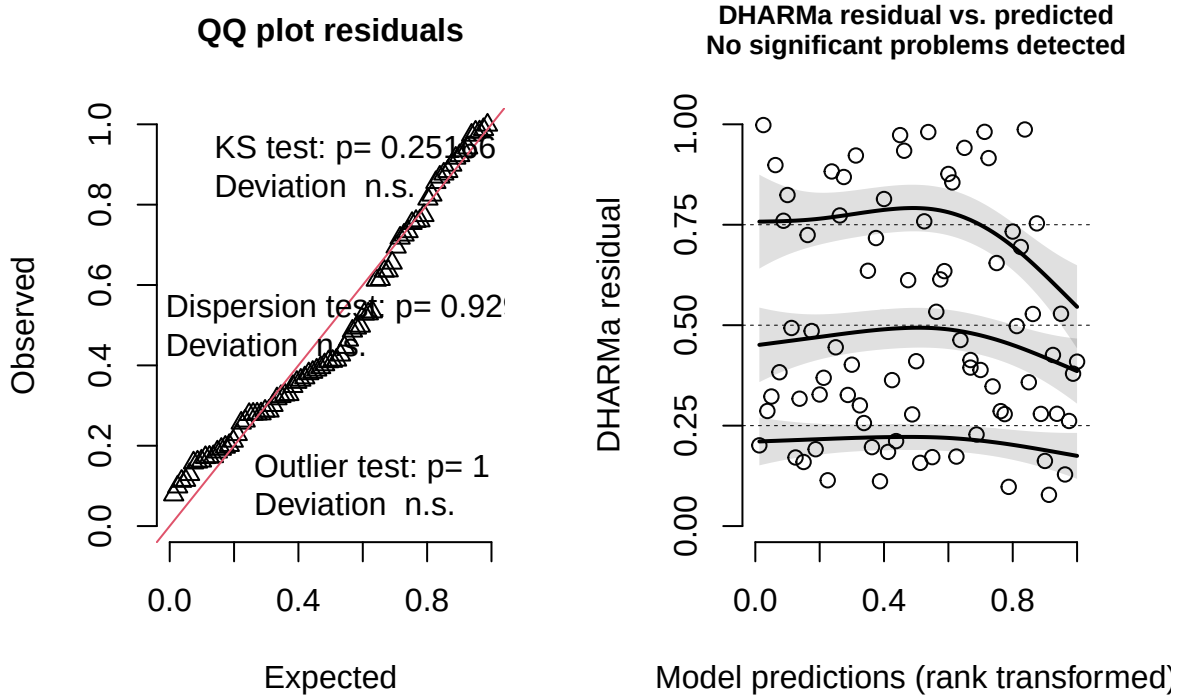
6.4 Change in the amount of compounds associated with *F. fusca*

```
## Linear mixed model fit by REML. t-tests use Satterthwaite's method ['lmerModLmerTest']
## Formula: corrected_mass_part ~ mean_delta + (1 | colony)
## Data: separation_data
##
## REML criterion at convergence: -171.5
##
## Scaled residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -1.8982 -0.6538 -0.1157  0.6326  2.3286
##
## Random effects:
## Groups Name Variance Std.Dev.
## colony (Intercept) 0.006545 0.08090
## Residual 0.003934 0.06272
## Number of obs: 80, groups: colony, 11
##
## Fixed effects:
## Estimate Std. Error df t value Pr(>|t|)
## (Intercept) 0.1739794 0.0267734 11.9815824 6.498 2.97e-05 ***
## mean_delta -0.0017124 0.0005453 68.3928213 -3.140 0.00249 **
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
```

```
## Correlation of Fixed Effects:  
##      (Intr)  
## mean_delta -0.307  
  
##  
## Shapiro-Wilk normality test  
##  
## data:  residuals(lm_model)  
## W = 0.96856, p-value = 0.04595
```



DHARMa residual



7 Impact of slave on the development of the *F. sanguinea* CHC profile

We analyzed the impact of *F. fusca* slaves on the CHC profile of callow *F. sanguinea* ants. In this experiment, *F. sanguinea* ants were isolated in pairs before eclosion, and their CHC profiles were analyzed at one of four time points marking their adult age. We then tested whether callow *F. sanguinea* ants were chemically more similar to their slave relatives from free-living colonies. Unrelated *F. fusca* ants served as a background group.”

7.1 Analysis based on all samples

```
## Empirical p-value for the chemical distance difference for the ants aged 1-3 days:0.00000
## Number of colonies used in the treatment of 1-3 days of separation: 9
## Empirical p-value for the chemical distance difference for the ants aged 8-10 days:0.00000
## Number of colonies used in the treatment of 8-10 days of separation: 9
## Empirical p-value for the chemical distance difference for the ants aged 17-20 days:0.00080
## Number of colonies used in the treatment of 17-20 days of separation: 9
```

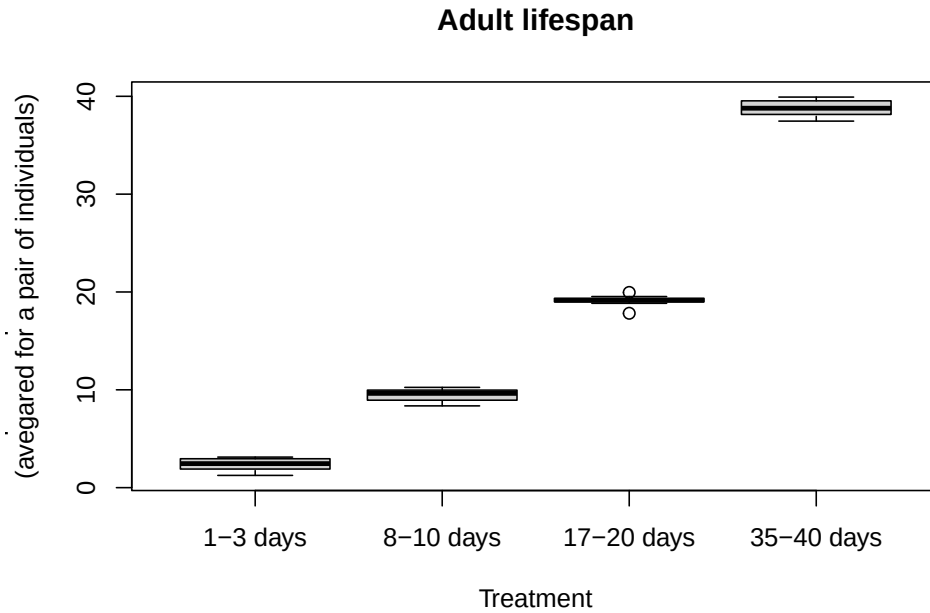


Figure S8 : Distribution of lifespans of ants used in the experiment. The precise age of individuals could not be determined because ants in pairs were not marked. Therefore, all possible combinations were considered to illustrate the potential range.

Table S3 : Chemical distance of the isolated *F. sanguinea* ant to *F. fusca* ants realted and unrelated to slaves.

Adult age	Chemical distance to slaves' relatives	Chemical distance to random colonies
1-3 days	0.3339	0.4723
8-10 days	0.3526	0.4809
17-20 days	0.4533	0.5296
35-40 days	0.5730	0.6101

Empirical p-value for the chemical distance difference for the ants aged 35-40 days:0.00705

Number of colonies used in the treatment of 35-40 days of separation: 8

7.2 Analysis restricted to the individuals hatched from cocoons

Since naked pupae might have acquired CHC through physical contact with adult ants after pupation, we subset our data to include only those samples which derived from the ants hatched from cocoons. In this case silky envelop during pupa stage ruled out possibility of the CHC transfer from the environment.

Empirical p-value for the chemical distance difference for the ants aged 1-3 days:0.00000

Number of colonies used in the treatment of 1-3 days of separation: 8

Empirical p-value for the chemical distance difference for the ants aged 8-10 days:0.00001

Table S4 : Chemical distance of the isolated *F. sanguinea* ant to *F. fusca* ants reated and unrelated to slaves. Isolated ant spun a silky envelope before pupal stage, which prevented CHC transfer from the enviroment.

Adult age	Chemical distance to slaves' relatives	Chemical distance to random colonies
1-3 days	0.3480	0.4875
8-10 days	0.3752	0.4941
17-20 days	0.4655	0.5413
35-40 days	0.6176	0.6458

```
## Number of colonies used in the treatment of 8-10 days of separation: 8

## Empirical p-value for the chemical distance difference for the ants aged 17-20 days:0.00453

## Number of colonies used in the treatment of 17-20 days of separation: 8

## Empirical p-value for the chemical distance difference for the ants aged 35-40 days:0.03298

## Number of colonies used in the treatment of 35-40 days of separation: 7
```

8 Effect of dummy ants

In these experiments, *F. sanguinea* ants released from their cocoon envelopes were maintained in Petri dishes along with glass beads coated with CHC extracted from either *F. fusca* or *F. sanguinea* ants. We examined whether the contact with dummy nestmates influenced the development of CHC profile of young *F. sanguinea* workers. In particular, we aimed to determine there there is evidence for active chemical mimicry in *F. sanguinea*.

8.1 Distance to the CHC profile of the dummy ants treated by *F. fusca* CHCs

We computed the chemical distance to the CHC profile of ants whose CHCs were used to cover glass beads serving as dummy ants. In the control variant, we used the ants subjected to clean glass beads.

```
##
## Wilcoxon signed rank exact test
##
## data: to_test$mean_dist.x and to_test$mean_dist.y
## V = 19, p-value = 0.7344
## alternative hypothesis: true location shift is not equal to 0
```

8.2 Distance to the CHC profile of the dummy ants treated by *F. sanguinea* CHCs

```
##
## Wilcoxon signed rank exact test
##
## data: to_test$mean_dist.x and to_test$mean_dist.y
## V = 15, p-value = 0.2324
## alternative hypothesis: true location shift is not equal to 0
```

Table S5 : Chemical distance of separated *F. sanguinea* ants to the CHC profile of *F. fusca* ants from colonies that served as a source of CHC to coat the glass beads. In control variant, glass bead were left clean.

Colony ID	Treatment	Averaged distance	Contrast	Averaged distance
SD18-3	12-15 days + <i>F. fusca</i> hydrocarbons	0.3957886	12-15 days (control)	0.5093071
SD18-5	12-15 days + <i>F. fusca</i> hydrocarbons	0.6157811	12-15 days (control)	0.5132649
SD18-5	12-15 days + <i>F. fusca</i> hydrocarbons	0.8423114	12-15 days (control)	0.8316840
SD19-11	12-15 days + <i>F. fusca</i> hydrocarbons	0.4665112	12-15 days (control)	0.4691791
SD19-3	12-15 days + <i>F. fusca</i> hydrocarbons	0.4996918	12-15 days (control)	0.4361776
SD19-4	12-15 days + <i>F. fusca</i> hydrocarbons	0.3049006	12-15 days (control)	0.4244113
SD19-6	12-15 days + <i>F. fusca</i> hydrocarbons	0.6735461	12-15 days (control)	0.6991620
SD19-8	12-15 days + <i>F. fusca</i> hydrocarbons	0.5954873	12-15 days (control)	0.5870741
SD20-2	12-15 days + <i>F. fusca</i> hydrocarbons	0.6985494	12-15 days (control)	0.7087854

Table S6 : Chemical distance of separated *F. sanguinea* ants to the CHC profile of *F. sanguinea* ants from colonies that served as a source of CHC to coat the glass beads. In control variant, glass bead were left clean.

Colony ID	Treatment	Averaged distance	Contrast	Averaged distance
SD18-2	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.5706616	12-15 days (control)	0.3734387
SD18-3	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.4565024	12-15 days (control)	0.5986922
SD18-5	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.5246184	12-15 days (control)	0.5800488
SD18-5	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.2501310	12-15 days (control)	0.2323064
SD19-11	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.5953242	12-15 days (control)	0.6070599
SD19-3	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.4185158	12-15 days (control)	0.5112225
SD19-4	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.6477936	12-15 days (control)	0.6680334
SD19-6	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.5525058	12-15 days (control)	0.5908247
SD19-8	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.8501448	12-15 days (control)	0.8499395
SD20-2	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.6460560	12-15 days (control)	0.6543900

Table S7 : Proportion of *n*-docosane in CHC extracted from *F. sanguinea* ants maintained with the glass beads coated with the CHC of *F. fusca* ants and contaminated with *n*-docosane. In control variant, glass bead were left clean.

Colony ID	Treamtent	Averaged C22 fraction	Contrast	Averaged C22 fraction
SD18-3	12-15 days + <i>F. fusca</i> hydrocarbons	0.0178168	12-15 days (control)	0.0000000
SD18-5	12-15 days + <i>F. fusca</i> hydrocarbons	0.0012056	12-15 days (control)	0.0000000
SD18-5	12-15 days + <i>F. fusca</i> hydrocarbons	0.0017152	12-15 days (control)	0.0003274
SD19-11	12-15 days + <i>F. fusca</i> hydrocarbons	0.0112850	12-15 days (control)	0.0019864
SD19-3	12-15 days + <i>F. fusca</i> hydrocarbons	0.0086141	12-15 days (control)	0.0009720
SD19-4	12-15 days + <i>F. fusca</i> hydrocarbons	0.0173323	12-15 days (control)	0.0000000
SD19-6	12-15 days + <i>F. fusca</i> hydrocarbons	0.0091910	12-15 days (control)	0.0011031
SD19-8	12-15 days + <i>F. fusca</i> hydrocarbons	0.0026387	12-15 days (control)	0.0021076
SD20-2	12-15 days + <i>F. fusca</i> hydrocarbons	0.0086688	12-15 days (control)	0.0049489
W17-1	12-15 days + <i>F. fusca</i> hydrocarbons	0.0211912	12-15 days (control)	0.0014942

8.3 Fraction of *n*-docosane in the CHC profile

For the control treatment, glass beads were left uncoated with CHC. In the experimental treatments, the CHC used to coat the glass beads were supplemented with *n*-docosane, which served as an internal standard. We examined differences in the proportion of *n*-docosane in the CHC profiles of the tested ants, as these could indicate the acquisition of chemicals from the dummy ants.

8.3.1 *F. fusca*

```
##
## Wilcoxon signed rank exact test
##
## data: to_test$C22_prop.x and to_test$C22_prop.y
## V = 55, p-value = 0.001953
## alternative hypothesis: true location shift is not equal to 0
```

8.3.2 *F. sanguinea*

```
##
## Wilcoxon signed rank exact test
##
## data: to_test$C22_prop.x and to_test$C22_prop.y
## V = 63, p-value = 0.004883
## alternative hypothesis: true location shift is not equal to 0
```

Table S8 : Proportion of *n*-docosane in CHC extracted from *F. sanguinea* ants maintained with the glass beads coated with the CHC of *F. sanguinea* ants and contaminated with *n*-docosane. In control variant, glass bead were left clean.

Colony ID	Treamtent	Averaged C22 fraction	Contrast	Averaged C22 fraction
SD18-2	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.0050660	12-15 days (control)	0.0016166
SD18-3	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.0141292	12-15 days (control)	0.0000000

SD18-5	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.0032893	12-15 days (control)	0.0000000
SD18-5	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.0021351	12-15 days (control)	0.0003274
SD19-11	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.0040419	12-15 days (control)	0.0019864
SD19-3	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.0032399	12-15 days (control)	0.0009720
SD19-4	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.0017680	12-15 days (control)	0.0000000
SD19-6	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.0035583	12-15 days (control)	0.0011031
SD19-8	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.0017423	12-15 days (control)	0.0021076
SD20-2	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.0043650	12-15 days (control)	0.0049489
W17-1	12-15 days + <i>F. sanguinea</i> hydrocarbons	0.0030204	12-15 days (control)	0.0014942

9 Body surface area of *F. sanguinea* ants and their slaves

In the publication, CHC amounts are reported relative to the square of head width. To assess whether this measure reliably reflects body size, we measured the planar projection areas of different body parts of *F. sanguinea* and *F. fusca*. The plots below suggest that head width slightly underestimates body surface area in *F. fusca* compared to *F. sanguinea*. As a result, the relative concentration of CHC in *F. fusca* may be overestimated. However, this bias acts in the opposite direction of our findings—*F. sanguinea* exhibits greater CHC concentration on its cuticle. Therefore, the shape-related bias between species is conservative, as it reduces the likelihood of rejecting the null hypothesis

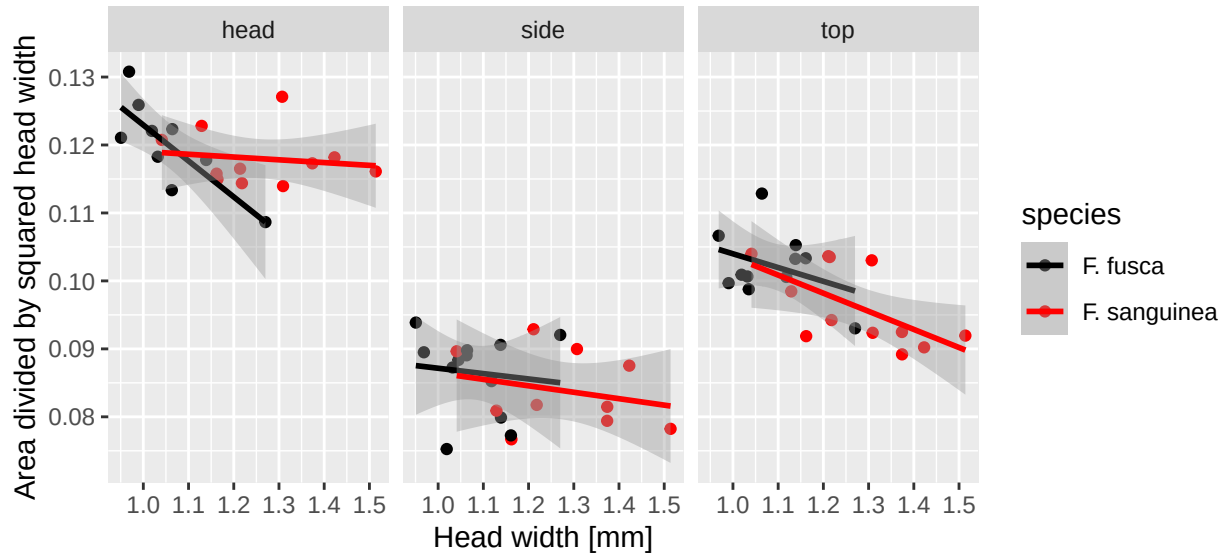


Figure S9 : Ratios of the planar projection areas of three body parts (head, thorax dorsal view, thorax lateral view) to the square of head width.

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